

Ryan Sandell

8 Gothic

1 The Gothic Language and Corpus

Within the Germanic language family, GOTHIC possesses the distinction both of being the earliest well-attested language, and of providing the only substantive documentation of the now-extinct East Germanic branch. Historically, Gothic is known to have been spoken in the area of present-day Romania, Moldova, and Ukraine above the Black Sea from at least the 3rd c. CE. During the 4th and 5th centuries CE, significant numbers of Gothic speakers migrated westwards into Italy, Gaul, and Iberia; in particular, an Ostrogothic kingdom centered on Ravenna (c. 493 – c. 553) and a Visigothic kingdom centered on Toulouse and later Toledo (c. 466 – c. 720) represented important political entities, with the former being primarily responsible for the transmission of Gothic-language texts that have survived to the present day. The Gothic language itself was almost certainly extinct in Western Europe by the middle of the 8th c. CE, though some Gothic-speaking communities evidently survived in Ukraine and Crimean Peninsula until as late as the 18th c. CE (see generally Stearns 1978). Linguistically, the East Germanic represented by Gothic constitutes a primary subgroup of the Germanic family, insofar as phonological and morphological innovations shared between West and North Germanic point to a common ancestor, Northwest Germanic (see Ringe and Taylor 2014, pp. 10–40; cf. also Hartmann and Riegger 2022 on the question of an East Germanic clade in particular).

The extant Gothic corpus (in total constituting about ~ 70000 tokens) consists entirely of manuscripts produced in Ostrogothic Italy during the 6th c. CE; the vast majority of this corpus consists of parts of a translation of the Bible to be dated to the middle of the 4th c. CE, traditionally attributed to a bishop Wulfila, active among the Gothic *Vesi*. Thus, the picture of Gothic afforded by its transmission mostly reflects the state of the language in the 4th c. CE (see Miller 2019, pp. 39–42 for arguments against any extensive linguistic “updating” of the Wulfilan texts), though a smaller amount of material was likely first composed in the 6th c. CE. The primary manuscripts are the *Codex Argenteus* (Gospels) and the *Codices Ambrosiani A and B* (Pauline Epistles). Other surviving texts are very short, but may preserve more original material not based on a translation (*Skeireins* ‘explanation’, *Codex Bononiensis*, Naples and Arezzo Deeds, plus marginal notes on a Latin homiletic text [*Gotica Veronensia*] and a Calendar in the *Codex Ambrosianus A*). See Falluomini 2015 for a complete list of all manuscripts containing any Gothic language materials and a thorough introduction to the textual bases of the corpus generally. The entirety of the corpus is available in a convenient digitization from Project Wulfila (Herdt et al. 2001) at wulfila.be/gothic; extensive tagging of morphosyntax and syntactic relations in the Gospels and Epistles is

available through the PROIEL project (Jøhndal et al. 2007, <http://foni.uio.no/proiel/>).

Given that the greater part of the Gothic corpus is a translation from originally Greek language sources, investigating properties of Gothic syntax and morphosyntax is complicated by possible translation effects. Indeed, a strong tendency to render each word in the Greek with a corresponding word in the Gothic stands out, and has predictably grave consequences for Gothic word order. In cases where the Gothic clearly departs from the Greek basis, however, one may safely assume that the resulting Gothic reflects absolutely genuine Gothic, since a more literal rendering of the Greek would have been either morphologically unavailable or syntactically ungrammatical. For the present study of reflexives in Gothic, precisely such a situation obtains in many instances: a synthetic middle in Greek, in particular when expressing a reflexive function, cannot be rendered by a corresponding synthetic verbal form in Gothic. Hence, one may safely assume that the reflexive constructions treated in this chapter constitute genuine features of Gothic syntax.

2 The Gothic Reflexive Constructions

Gothic possesses two distinct reflexive constructions, which are, however, morphologically and historically closely related. As will be introduced here and further described under the relevant variables below, Gothic appears to have developed the major features of a two-reflexive system, with the distributions of the two constructions being very similar to those found in Dutch and the Scandinavian languages (cf. Ferraresi 2005, pp. 86–90 and Harbert 2007, pp. 204–211). Both constructions are characterized principally by the usage of morphologically independent pronominal forms; Table 1 provides complete paradigms of the Gothic reflexive pronouns for all person and number combinations (see further 3.1); nominative forms are struck through since they are not available for reflexive use and presumed dual forms are given in parentheses since these are not attested in a reflexive construction in the Gothic corpus. Construction 1, which I will refer to as the “simplex *sik* construction”, consists in one of the pronominal forms shown in Table 1 alone; these pronominal forms by themselves are phonologically likely clitics (see further 3.6 and 3.7), and are nearly always placed in a position following a verb (see 3.2). Construction 2, which I will label as the “complex *sik silba* construction”, likewise employs a pronominal from Table 1, which is nearly always immediately followed by a form of the intensifier *silba*- ‘self’, which then must agree with the reflexive pronoun in case and number (see 3.1.2 and 3.5); Table 2 shows the inflection of *silba*-, an *a*-stem adjective, in its masculine gender weak forms (neuter *sik silbo* at Rom. 14.14 appears to be the only instance of a non-masculine form of *silba*- involving Construction 2; strong forms of *silba*- are vanishingly rare, if they occur at all).

Tab. 1: Inflectional Paradigm of Reflexive Anaphors in Gothic

		1	2	3
SG	NOM	(ik)	(pu)	—
	ACC	mik	þuk	sik
	GEN	meina	þeina	seina
	DAT	mis	þus	sis
PL	NOM	(weis)	(jus)	—
	ACC	uns, unsis	izwis	sik
	GEN	unsara	izwara	seina
	DAT	unsis	izwis	sis
DU	NOM	(wit)	(—)	—
	ACC	(ugkis)	(igqis)	(sik)
	GEN	(—)	(igqara)	(seina)
	DAT	(ugkis)	(igqis)	(sis)

Tab. 2: Inflectional Paradigm of *silba*- ‘self’ in Gothic

	SG	PL
NOM	silba	silbans
ACC	silban	silbans
GEN	silbins	silbane*
DAT	silbin	silbam

Example (1) presents a relatively typical instance of a direct reflexive in the third person singular, *bliggwands sik* ‘beating himself’, employing the simplex *sik* construction; this particular example is also notable for the occurrence of a reflexive anaphor with a non-finite form (see further 3.10). Since the third person forms seen in Table 1 are precisely restricted to reflexive usage (see again 3.1), I take all occurrences in the corpus containing one of *sik*, *seina*, or *sis* to instantiate one of the reflexive constructions, while occurrences of the corresponding first and second singular forms may represent reflexives, depending on context.¹ Any case in which a pronominal from Table 1 is immediately linearly followed (or, in rare instances, preceded) by a form of *silba*- is necessarily taken to constitute a reflexive. Throughout this chapter, the terms “Construction 1 (= simplex *sik* construction)” and “Construction 2 (= complex *sik silba* construction)” thus refer to a clause or sentence in which one of the forms seen in

¹ The GEN.3SG *seina* is homophonous with the F.NOM/ACC.SG and N.NOM/ACC.PL forms of the reflexive possessive adjective, on which see (3.27).

Table 1 occurs together with a specifically reflexive reading or a reading involving some established equivalence set (e.g. anticausative).

(1) *bliggwan* ‘beat, harm’ with *sik* ‘himself’, Mark 5.5

<i>jah</i>	<i>sinteino</i>	<i>nahtam</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>dagam</i>	<i>in</i>
and	always	night.DAT.PL	and	day.DAT.PL	in
<i>aurahjom</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>fairgunjam</i>		
tomb.DAT.PL	and	in	mountain.DAT.PL		
<i>was_i</i>	<i>hropjands_i</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>bliggwands_i</i>	<i>sik_i</i>	<i>stainam</i>
be.PST.3SG	cry.PTCP.NPST.NOM	and	beat.PTCP.NPST.NOM	REFL.3.ACC	stone.DAT.PL

‘and always, night and day, he was in the tombs and in the mountains, crying and beating himself with stones’

(*bliggwands sik* translates Greek *katakóptōn heautōn* ‘cutting himself’)

Historically, Construction 2 transparently reflects an expansion of Construction 1 with the intensifier *silba-* ‘self’ (as in many other Germanic languages; cf. e.g. Dutch *zich* and *zichzelf*), and many instances of Construction 2 are indeed still compatible with a reading as a mere expansion of Construction 1; for instance, both constructions are licit as an anaphor of a transitive verb (direct reflexive; see 3.11), as the pair of examples (2) and (3) demonstrate: with the verb *frijon* ‘love’, either *sik* or *sik silban* as its direct object is acceptable. However, several syntactic distributional restrictions, combined with statistical evidence indicating preferences for one or the other construction in cases where both are permitted, strongly suggest that two distinct constructions are available.

First, only the complex *sik silba* construction allows for considerations of information structure to determine its position (see 3.2), and only it may be coordinated with a DP or be employed in equative usages (see 3.3); the simplex *sik* construction, on the other hand, virtually only occurs to the right of verbal roots and person markers, and admits of neither coordination with other constituents nor equative usage. These facts suffice to draw the conclusion that Construction 2 constitutes a full DP, while Construction 1 does not. Furthermore, in cases involving an inherently reflexive verb (usually rendering a Greek mediopassive; see e.g. *skama mik* ‘I am ashamed’ in (7)), including oppositional anticausatives, the reflexive pronoun is not associated with a semantic argument role, and in such cases, only the simplex reflexive without *silba-* is permissible. Likewise, the simplex reflexive alone is obligatory in apparent cases of long-distance reflexives (see 3.25), where the DP with which the reflexive is coreferential is outside the boundary of the infinitive or participial clause containing the reflexive.

(2) Simplex *sik*, 2 Tim. 3.2

<i>jah</i>	<i>wairþand</i>	<i>mannans</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>frijondans</i>	(<i>B</i> <i>frijondans</i>)
and	become.NPST.3PL	man.NOM.PL	REFL.3.ACC	love.PTCP.NPST.NOM.PL	

‘and men shall become lovers of themselves’

(3) Complex *sik silba*, Eph. 5.28

saei *silba* qen frijop, jah *sik* *silban* frijop
 REL.NOMPOSS. .ACC love.NPST.3SG and REFL.3.ACC self.ACC love.NPST.3SG
 REFL.ACC
 ‘he who loves his wife loves himself’

On the other hand, when the verb is transitive and the object and subject of the verb are coreferential, the simplex reflexive is permitted, but the complex *sik silba* construction seems to be preferred. Especially in the first and second person, Construction 2 appears to be statistically predominant, and is perhaps also preferred when a reflexive anaphor falls in the complement of a preposition.² For instance, the 1SG.ACC pronoun *mik* occurs in the Gothic corpus 250 times,³ of which 20 instances constitute reflexives outside a prepositional phrase; 10 of these are the complex anaphor *mik silban*, 9 of which occur with normally transitive verbs (*hauhjan* ‘exalt’, *gabairhtjan* ‘manifest’, *weiha* ‘sanctify’, *rahnjan* ‘reckon’, *ussokjan* ‘judge, examine’, *haunjan* ‘abase’, *fastan* ‘keep’, *ustai knja* ‘prove’, *gafahan* ‘apprehend’), and one is an equative, while 9 of the remaining 10 instances of simplex reflexive *mik* occur with inherent reflexives or verbs semantically belonging to the categories under 3.19 (*skaman* ‘be ashamed’, *andþagkjan* ‘intend’, *idreigon* ‘repent’, *wenjan* ‘hope’, *ufþanjan* ‘stretch’, *galisjan* ‘learn’), and one instance occurs in an infinitival clause (*lais jah haunjan mik* ‘and I know how to be abased’), where complex anaphors are less typical (or, depending on binding relations, not possible).

Taken together, all of this evidence indicates that complex *sik silba* has the syntax of a DP, and is thus restricted to use as an argument; simplex *sik*, on the other hand, does not have the syntax of a DP, and thus can, but need not, saturate an argument position. In the five-way typology of reflexives posited by Déchaine and Wiltschko 2017, pp. 64–70, the morphologically simplex *sik* construction is then likely syntactically integrated as a voice head and distributed as a clitic (similar to French *se*), whereas the morphologically complex *sik silba* is syntactically integrated and distributed as a DP (similar to English *myself*).

² As regards the latter point, Gothic exhibits binding conditions similar to those of English: a prepositional phrase in the same clause with a complement that is coreferential with the subject of the clause cannot use the personal pronoun as a reflexive. This means, effectively, that wherever English *myself*, *ourselves*, *yourself*, *yourselves* would be obligatory in translation of a prepositional complement, Gothic presents a complex anaphor with *silba*-. Since participles have subjects in Gothic, their subjects also bind reflexives, leading to cases where Gothic has a complex anaphor, but English admits the non-reflexive pronoun, e.g. *habands uf mis silbin gadrauhtins* ‘(I am) having under me (*myself) soldiers’ (Luke 7.8).

³ A search in the electronic corpus of Project Wulfila returns 279 tokens, but 29 of these are repetitions of passages that are found in both the Codex Ambrosianus A and B, and one is repeated in both the Codex Argenteus and the Codex Ambrosianus C.

Treatments of both general features of and specific problems regarding the Gothic reflexive construction are hardly wanting in the literature, and this chapter is much indebted to this earlier work. While I have made a good-faith effort to ferret out all functions of reflexives, it is possible that some rarer usages have been overlooked or are accidentally unattested, given the small corpus. Not every specific variable discussed in this chapter has received a detailed treatment in the literature, but the works cited here furnish a more than adequate portrait of what properties Gothic reflexives generally do and do not exhibit. The discussion of anaphoric structures, the binding of anaphors, and overlap between reflexives and anticausatives (see 3.17 below) found in the recent grammar of Miller 2019, pp. 283–296 provides a solid grounding. Typical examples of reflexive usage and exemplification of the semantic range of verbs found with reflexives are provided in Klimov 1983 and Rousseau 2016, pp. 305–329. Rose 1976 and Harbert 1978, pp. 34–72 both offer detailed syntactic analyses of the generation of reflexives, with many useful examples, though the formalisms employed are rather outdated. Ferraresi 1996 and Ferraresi 2005, Ch. 3 situate Gothic reflexives in a broader typology of reflexive pronouns and the typology of middles; the latter chapter constitutes perhaps the best available overview of Gothic reflexives from a syntactic perspective, even if Ferraresi’s views on the capacity of the synthetic passive to express middle functions (see immediately below) are probably incorrect. Harbert 2007, pp. 196–214 helpfully situates the Gothic material in a broader cross-Germanic perspective, while Ottosson 2013 does so for anticausatives specifically.

Before delving into a systematic treatment of the specific properties of the two Gothic reflexive constructions, I must clarify one possible point of confusion and periodically recurring contention, in part to strictly absolve this chapter of any responsibility for offering coverage of a further construction that might (presumably) express reflexive or middle functions. This concerns the functional range of the Gothic morphological category characterized by inflectional endings that historically continue inflectional endings of the Proto-Indo-European mediopassive category, cognate with inflectional suffixes in Sanskrit and Ancient Greek (e.g. PASS.2_{SG}-*za* < PIE *[-so], PASS.3_{SG}-*da* < PIE *[-to]); a sample paradigm is provided in Table 3, showing that the category is available in the non-past (“present”) tense, with distinct endings for indicative and optative mood, but extensive person syncretism. As the labeling there betrays, I follow the *communis opinio*, represented in virtually all handbooks (e.g. Streitberg 1920, p. 139, Miller 2019, p. 176) and article-length treatments of the category (e.g. Brugmann 1921 and most recently Ratkus 2020), that this category is strictly to be identified as a PASSIVE, not a mediopassive or middle (even if the term “mediopassive” is sometimes applied to it on account of its aforementioned historical background). Example (4) shows an entirely typical usage: the vast majority of verbal forms exhibiting the inflectional endings of Table 3 clearly require a passive reading or are easily susceptible to such a reading.

Tab. 3: Passive inflection of *niman* ‘take’ (Strong Class 4)

	NPST.PASS	NPST.OPT.PASS
1SG	nim-a-da*	nim-ai-dau*
2SG	nim-a-za*	nim-ai-zau*
3SG	(af)-nim-a-da	nim-ai-dau*
PL	nim-a-nda*	nim-ai-ndau*

(4) Luke 6.38

gibaid *jah gibada* *izwis*
 give.NPST.OPT.2PL and give.NPST.PASS.3SG 2PL.DAT
 ‘Give, and (it) will be given to you (PL)’

Nonetheless, attempts to read properly middle functions into the Gothic (medio)passive are not few in number: Guxman 1959, Ferraresi 2005, pp. 97–124, Lühr 2008, pp. 319–327, and most recently, Kleyner 2019 all contain arguments to the effect that at least some few instances of verbs belonging to the category in Table 3 may be read as e.g. indirect reflexives. See, however, Ringe 2017, p. 194 (responding in particular to the claims in Ferraresi 2005) and, in extensive detail, Ratkus 2020, for arguments that the category in question is strictly a passive, and not used to express any middle functions. Forms like *gibada* ‘give.NPST.PASS.3SG’ seen in example (4) will therefore be left entirely out of consideration in the remainder of this chapter.

3 Variables

3.1 Inflection

3.1.1 Construction 1

As the inflectional paradigm of the reflexive pronouns given in Table 1 above indicates, person is systematically distinguished in Gothic in the marking of reflexives. Examples (5), (6), and (7) show instances of formally distinct third, second, and first person reflexives, respectively.

guish number, lacks a nominative case form altogether, and is invariant for gender, whereas the latter presents distinct inflectional forms conditioned on all the morpho-syntactic categories of number, case, and gender (cf. Miller 2019, p. 84).

In terms of number marking, Gothic once again presents a division between the first and second person versus the third person: the first two persons consistently distinguish number in reflexives, just as in the formally identical free anaphors, whereas the third person is the same in both singular and plural (with no dual forms attested). Compare and contrast examples (9), (10), and (11) of plural reflexives immediately below with the corresponding singular forms in examples (5), (6), and (7) above. Observe that, in the case of the third person, *sik* is found for both singular and plural. Also notice that, where Construction 2 is employed in (10) and (11), the intensifier *silba-* agrees with the pronoun in number.

(9) Third Person Plural *sik*, John 18.18

<i>par=uh</i>	<i>stopun</i>	<i>skalkos</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>andbahtos</i>	<i>haurja</i>
there=and	stand.PST.3PL	servant. NOM.PL	and	officer.NOM.PL	coal.ACC.PL
<i>waurkjandans,</i>	<i>unte</i>	<i>kald</i>	<i>was,</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>warmidedun_i</i>
make.PTCP.NPST. NOM.PL	for	cold	be.PST.3SG	and	warm.PST.3PL
<i>sik_i</i>	...				
REFL.3.ACC	...				

‘and all of the servants and officers were standing there making (a fire of) coals, for it was cold, and they_i warmed themselves_i’

(10) Second Person Plural *izwis silbans*, 2 Cor. 13.5

<i>izwis</i>	<i>silbans</i>	<i>fragip</i>	<i>sijaid=u</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>galaubeinai;</i>	
2PL.ACC	self.ACC.PL	ask.NPST.IMP.2PL	be.NPST.OPT.	in	faith.DAT	
			2PL=whether			
<i>silbans</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>kauseip,</i>	<i>pau(h)</i>	<i>ni=u</i>	<i>kunnup</i>	<i>izwis</i>
self.ACC.PL	2PL.ACC	test.NPST.IMP.2PL	or	NEG=Q	know.NPST.2PL	2PL.ACC
<i>patei</i>	<i>Iesus</i>	<i>Xristus</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>ist?</i>	
that/how	I.NOM	C.NOM	in	2PL.DAT	be.NPST.3SG	

‘ask yourselves, whether you are in the faith; test yourselves. Do you not know yourselves, how Jesus Christ is in you?’

- (11) First Person Plural
- unsis silbans, uns*
- (cf. Miller 2019, 385), 2 Cor. 10.12

<i>unte</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>gadaursum_i</i>	<i>domjan</i>	<i>unsis_i</i>	<i>silbans</i>	<i>aiþþau</i>
for	NEG	dare.NPST.1PL	judge.INF	1PL.ACC	self.ACC.PL	or
<i>gadamjan_i</i>	<i>uns_i</i>	<i>du</i>	<i>þaim_j</i>	<i>sik_j</i>	<i>silbans</i>	<i>anafilhandam_j</i> ...
compare.INF	1PL.ACC	with	those.DAT.PL	REFL.3	self.ACC.PL	(re)commend. ...
PTCP.NPST.DAT.PL						

‘For we dare not judge ourselves or compare ourselves with those (who) commend themselves...’

Reflexive pronouns in Gothic may be marked for and formally distinguished in accusative, genitive, and dative case. Example (12), continuing the passage from example (11), shows instances of accusative *sik* alongside dative *sis*. When the complex *sik silba* construction is used, agreement in case between the reflexive pronoun and the adjectival intensifier *silba-* is also obligatory, as shown in (13) (contrast e.g. accusative *sik silban* in (3) above).

- (12) Distinct Accusative and Dative Reflexives, 2 Cor. 10.12

...	<i>ak</i>	<i>eis</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>silbam</i>	<i>sik</i>
...	but	3PL.NOM	in	REFL.3.DAT	self.DAT.PL	REFL.3.ACC
[<i>sik</i>]	<i>silbans</i>	<i>mitandans</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>gadamjandans</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>silbans</i>
[REFL.3.ACC]	self.ACC.PL	measure.	and	compare.PTCP.	REFL.3.ACC	self.ACC.PL
		PTCP.NPST.NOM.PL		NPST.NOM.PL		
<i>du</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>silbam</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>frapjand</i>		
with	REFL.3.DAT	self.DAT.PL	not	be.wise.NPST.3PL		
`...rather, they (who) measure themselves against themselves and compare themselves with themselves are not wise'						

- (13) Case Agreement between Reflexive Pronoun and Intensifier (cf. Miller 2019, p. 537), John 8.22

<i>qepun</i>	<i>þan</i>	<i>Iudaieis:</i>	<i>nibai</i>	<i>usqimai</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>silbin</i>	...
say.PST.3PL	then	jew.NOM.PL	NEG.Q	kill.NPST.	REFL.3.DAT	self.DAT	
OPT.3SG							

‘Then the Jews said: he isn’t going to kill himself, is he?’

Thus, although the Gothic nominal system regularly distinguishes four cases in inflection (nominative, accusative, genitive, and dative), reflexive pronominals only distinguish three, not being permitted in the nominative case. In other words, nominative case in the Gothic pronominal system is compatible only with free anaphors. As such, the dedicated third person reflexive pronoun lacks a corresponding nominative form altogether (see Table 1).

1. PERSON

Is the reflexive marker specified for person? yes

2. PERSON RESTRICTIONS

Is the reflexive marker restricted to certain persons? no

3. RESTRICTION TO REFLEXIVE CONSTRUCTIONS

Is the marker or one of the paradigmatically related markers restricted to the use in the construction that expresses reflexives? no (1/2 person); yes (3 person)

4. NUMBER

Is the reflexive marker specified for number? yes

5. CASE

Is the reflexive marker specified for case? yes

6. NUMBER OF CASES

Is case restricted to a subset of the cases attested with (other) pronouns? If yes, to how many? 3

3.1.2 Construction 2

When Construction 2 is employed, the pronominal component is specified for person, exactly as in examples (5)–(13) shown just above, but the intensifier component *silba-* is not, since adjectives in Gothic do not inflect for person whatsoever. In all other respects concerning inflectional properties, Construction 2 behaves identically to Construction 1.

1. PERSON: yes
2. PERSON RESTRICTIONS: no
3. RESTRICTION TO REFLEXIVE CONSTRUCTIONS: yes
4. NUMBER: yes
5. CASE: yes
6. NUMBER OF CASES 3

3.2 Position relative to the verb

3.2.1 Construction 1

In the case of a simplex reflexive such as 1SG.ACC *mik* or 3SG.DAT *sis* alone without *silba-*, the reflexive pronoun almost exceptionlessly follows the verb, regardless of whether the verb is finite or non-finite. Compare the position of the reflexive pronouns (excepting the 3SG reflexive anaphors in prepositional phrases) in examples (5), (6), (7), (9), and (11) above. In all instances, whether the reflexive is direct (as in (6)), indirect (as in (5)), or inherent (as in (7)), and even in cases when the verb is non-finite (as in (1)), the reflexive pronoun stands immediately to the right of the verb, linearly speaking. This generalization furthermore holds regardless of the position of the verb in the clause: (14) below presents an instance in which a participle *andhamonds* ‘undress.

PTCP.NPST.NOM' occurs as the first constituent, immediately followed by *sik*, which may be contrasted with example (5) above, where *sik* follows the verb *ushaihah* 'hang. PST.3SG' at the end of the clause.

(14) Verb + reflexive pronoun clause-initially, Col. 2.15

<i>andhamonds</i>	<i>sik_i</i>	<i>leika,</i>	<i>reikja</i>	
undress.PTCP.NPST.	REFL.3.ACC	body.DAT	kingdom.NOM/	
NOM.PL			ACC.PL	
<i>jah</i>	<i>waldufnja_i</i>	<i>gatarhida_j</i>	<i>balþaba,</i>	
and	power.NOM/	mark.PST.3SG	candid/public	
	ACC.PL			
<i>gablaupjands_j</i>	<i>þo_i</i>	<i>bairhtaba</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>sis_j</i>
triumph.PTCP.NPST.	3PL.NOM/ACC	brilliantly	in	REFL.3.DAT
NOM				

'(and) being undressed with respect to the body (i.e. disarmed), he (i.e. Christ) publicly marked the kingdoms and powers, triumphing over them brilliantly in himself'

To my knowledge, only two instances known in the Gothic corpus show a departure from this positional dependency for Construction 1; both cases involve 3SG.ACC*sik*. These deviations from the usual rule seen in (15) *lacks* any obvious explanation; in the case of (16), the fact that two conjoined transitive verbs, *afdomeiþ* 'curses' and *gawargeiþ* 'condemns', both have a reflexive third person as their direct object, but one pronoun is omitted on the surface, may have conditioned the exceptional placement of *sik*.

(15) *sik* precedes finite *gaþarbaiþ* (cf. Ferraresi 2005, p. 88), 1 Cor. 9.25

<i>iþ</i>	<i>hazuh</i>	<i>saei</i>	<i>haifstjan</i>	<i>sniwiþ</i>	<i>allis</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>gaþarbaiþ</i>
but	every.NOM	REL.NOM	compete.INF	hasten.	all.GEN	REFL.3.ACC	abstain.NPST.3SG
				NPST.3SG			

'but every man that strives to compete (lit. 'fight') is temperate in all things'

(16) *sik* precedes a conjoined pair of finite verbs, *afdomeiþ jah gawargeiþ* (cf. Miller 2019, p. 502), Bologna Fragment 2r.24-25

...	<i>akei</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>þammei</i>	<i>afaikiþ</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>þam-/-ma</i>
...	but	in	REL.DAT	deny.NPST.3SG	in	that.DAT
<i>sik</i>	<i>afdomeiþ</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>gawargeiþ</i>	<i>jabai</i>	<i>n=ist</i>	<i>G(u)þ</i>
REFL.3.ACC	curse.NPST.3SG	and	condemn.	if	NEG=be.	god.NOM
			NPST.3SG		NPST.3SG	

'but in whomever he denies in that he curses and condemns himself if it is not god'

Hence, as a general rule, the Gothic reflexive pronoun by itself in the simplex *sik* construction virtually never occurs to the left of the verbal root. For several examples of this usual position to the right of the verb, see under 3.1; for two exceptions, see examples (15) and (16) immediately above.

Given that person agreement in Gothic is consistently expressed through suffixes on the verbal stem (e.g. *stop-un* ‘stand.PST-3PL’), and that the reflexive pronoun in Construction 1 consistently occurs to the right of the inflected verb, the reflexive pronoun in turn is consistently found to the right of person markers, and virtually never to their left. See again immediately above for reference to relevant examples.

In addition, since reflexivity in Gothic is expressed exclusively through morphologically independent pronominals (plus the intensifier *silba-* in Construction 2), which inflect solely according to case, person, and (in the first and second persons) number, reflexive markers like *sik* are in no way involved in the cumulative expression of further verbal inflectional categories. Tense and mood, for instance, are expressed on verbs exclusively through changes in the form of the verbal root and/or the addition of suffixes (see Streitberg 1920, p. 139–154 or Miller 2019, p. 176–206 for a basic overview of Gothic verbal inflection and stem formation).

Finally, given the evidently strict linearization restrictions placed on the simplex *sik* construction, considerations of information structure seem to be unable to affect the position of the reflexive pronominal with respect to the verb.

7. POSITIONAL DEPENDENCY

Is the position of the reflexive marker dependent on the position of the verb? yes

8. POSITION PRE

Can the marker occur to the left of the verbal root? no

9. POSITION POST Can the marker occur to the right of the verbal root? yes

10. POSITION RELATIVE TO PERSON MARKER LEFT

Can the marker occur to the left of the person marker? no

11. POSITION RELATIVE TO PERSON MARKER RIGHT

Can the marker occur to the right of the person marker? yes

12. CUMULATIVITY

Can the marker express, in addition to reflexivity, any other verbal inflectional categories such as tense, illocution, or mood in a cumulative way? no

13. INFORMATION STRUCTURE

Can information structure determine the positioning of the marker? no

3.2.2 Construction 2

Construction 2, on the other hand, may freely depart from the linearization restriction treated just above, evident in cases like *izwis silbans fragiþ* ‘ask yourselves’ from (10), though at least a slight statistical preference for the position following the verb re-

mains.⁴ The capacity of the complex *sik silba* construction to escape from the conditions that demand the placement of simplex *sik* immediately after the verb means that Construction 2 exhibits no clear positional dependencies; instead, positions both preceding and following the verb are permitted, likely conditioned by information structure or possibly by influence from the position of a reflexive pronoun in the Greek model.

Thus, when a reflexive pronoun is combined with *silba*- ‘self’ to build a complex reflexive (= Construction 2), e.g. *sik silban*, the complex reflexive is permitted to occur to the left of the inflected verb. Ostensibly, such cases in which a complex reflexive occurs outside of the usual position to the right of the verb (contrast 3.2.1 and footnote 4 on the statistical tendencies of Construction 2’s placement), the position of the reflexive is motivated by information structure, plausibly occupying a topic position in (17) or a focus position in (18) (cf. also Ferraresi 2005, p. 88).⁵ The particular choice of linearization in both instances may well be a consequence of influence from the Greek model, since in both cases a Greek reflexive pronoun precedes the verb.

(17) *sik silban* fronted, Eph. 5.25

<i>swaswe</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>Xristus_i</i>	<i>frijoda</i>	<i>akklesjon</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>sik_i</i>	<i>silban</i>
as	and	C.NOM	love.PST.3SG	church.ACC	and	REFL.3.ACC	self.ACC
<i>atgaf</i>	<i>faur</i>	<i>þo</i>					
give.over.PST.3SG	for	that.ACC					

‘just as Christ also loved the church and gave himself over for it (i.e. on its behalf)’

(18) *ik mik silban* fronted, Phil. 3.13

<i>broþrjus,</i>	<i>ik</i>	<i>mik</i>	<i>silban</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>nauh</i>	<i>man</i>	<i>gafahan</i>
brother.NOM/VOC.PL	1SG.NOM	1SG.ACC	self.ACC	NEG	still	believe.	comprehend.INF
						NPST.1SG	

‘Brethren, I do not consider myself to have comprehended’

Finally, just like Construction 1, the complex *sik silba* construction exhibits no cumulative expression of inflectional categories, for the same reasons as laid out above.

7. POSITIONAL DEPENDENCY: no
8. POSITION PRE: yes
9. POSITION POST: yes
10. POSITION RELATIVE TO PERSON MARKER LEFT: yes
11. POSITION RELATIVE TO PERSON MARKER RIGHT: yes

⁴ Of 50 instances of ACC.sg *mik/puk/sik silban* as an argument of a verb, in 30 instances (60%) the reflexive follows the verb, while in 20 instances (40%) it precedes it.

⁵ Example 18 constitutes an apparently unique case in the corpus where a pronoun in the nominative immediately precedes Construction 2 to the left of the verb. One plausible interpretation in context is that *ik* occupies a topic position (the sentence there follows several sentences with a 1st person subject) and that *mik silban* occupies a lower focus position.

12. CUMULATIVITY: **no**13. INFORMATION STRUCTURE: **no**

3.3 Syntactic Status

3.3.1 Construction 1

Just like the position of the reflexive marker with respect to the verb, the coordinability of reflexives with other NPs or DPs in Gothic probably also depends on the distinction between simplex reflexives on the one hand and complex reflexives built with *silba-* ‘self’ on the other hand. Simplex reflexives present no instances of coordination in the corpus, which is to be expected if the reflexive pronouns do not constitute DPs; similarly, no evidence for equations involving simplex reflexives exists, nor does the construction allow itself to be extended with a possessive pronoun or adjective.

In contrast, reflexive pronouns in Gothic are not infrequently found together with verbs whose semantics are typical of unaccusative verbs in languages in which syntactic unaccusativity is clearly diagnosable, e.g., *gaheilan* ‘stay’ (cf. Ital. *è rimasto* ‘he stayed’), *gaqiman* ‘come’ (cf. Ital. *è venuto* ‘he came’), *gaskaidan* ‘depart’ (cf. Ital. *è partito* ‘he departed’), *anadringkan* ‘get drunk’ (cf. Ital. *si è ubriacato* ‘he got drunk’); see further (3.19) below. On that basis, one might be tempted to infer for Gothic that at least some unaccusative predicates may be marked by a reflexive. However, for the verbs mentioned here and other plausible candidates there is unfortunately scant material in the corpus to which direct tests of unaccusativity can be applied: instances of past passive participles as adnominal modifiers are not abundant,⁶ and Gothic possesses neither an analytic perfect construction nor any obligatory subject or object clitics. Nonetheless, a handful of instances of adnominal (i.e. attributive) past passive participles indicate unaccusativity, and in some such cases the verb is attested in a reflexive construction as well. In example (19) a. presents a case of the past passive participle of *gawasjan* ‘clothe (oneself)’ used as an attributive adjective, while b. presents a case of the same verb as a simplex reflexive.⁷

⁶ In the PROIEL corpus, a total of 101 tokens are tagged as attributive past passive participles.

⁷ *gawasjan* acts as a labile verb Gothic in a fashion similar to the well-known English labile verbs of the type *break* or *melt*, with the difference that the corresponding intransitive may be reflexive marked. Note further that reading *gawisidana* in (19) as anything other than an adnominal past passive participle is morphologically excluded. If the form were a synthetic passive of the type illustrated in (4), it would be *gawasjada*, and if it were an analytic passive, it would be *gawasidana ist*, where the auxiliary *ist* would be obligatory, as established by Meillet 1908, p. 94 (cf. Miller 2019, p. 509) – an analytic passive without an auxiliary form of *wisan* ‘be’ or *wairþan* ‘become’ is excluded.

(19) *gawasjan* ‘clothe (oneself)’: unaccusative and reflexive, Matt. 11.8

a. Unaccusativity test: attributive past passive participle

<i>akei</i>	<i>hva</i>	<i>usiddjedup</i>	<i>saihan?</i>	<i>mannan</i>
but	what.ACC	go.out.NPST.2PL	see.INF	man.ACC
<i>hnasqjaim</i>	<i>wasjom</i>	<i>gawasidana?</i>		
soft.DAT.PL	garment.	clothe.PTCP.		
	DAT.PL	PST.PASS.ACC		

‘But what did you go out to see? A man clothed in soft garments?’

b. Reflexive usage⁸, Matt. 6.29

<i>qip=uh</i>	<i>þan</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>þatei</i>	<i>nih</i>
say.NPST.1SG=and	then	2PL.DAT	that	not.even
<i>Saulaumon</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>allamma</i>	<i>wulþau</i>	<i>seinamma</i>
S.NOM	in	all.DAT	glory.DAT	REFL.POSS.3.DAT.PL
<i>gawasida</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>swe</i>	<i>ains</i>	<i>þize</i>
clothe.PST.3SG	REFL.3.ACC	as	one.NOM	this.GEN.PL

‘And I say then to you that not even Solomon in all his glory clothed himself like one of these’

Certainly, however, not all verbs diagnosable as unaccusative through the test employed in (19) a. admit of cooccurrence with a reflexive pronoun. *urrisan* ‘arise, stand up’, for instance, appears as an attributive past passive participle at 2 Tim. 2.8 (*Xristu Iesu urrisanana us dauþaim* ‘Jesus Christ was arisen from the dead’), and the lemma is frequent in the Gothic corpus (25×), but never occurs in a reflexive construction. In light of the available data, I cautiously conclude that reflexive marking is compatible with unaccusativity in Gothic, but it may be limited to verbs of motion and verbs that admit of underived transitive-intransitive alternations through reflexivity (like the case of *gawasjan* ‘clothe (oneself)’).

14. COORDINATION

Is it possible to coordinate the reflexive with an NP/DP? no

15. EQUATION

Can the reflexive be used in equations? no

16. MODIFICATION

Can the reflexive be constructed with a possessive? no

17. OPTIONALITY OF MODIFICATION

If so, is the possessive obligatory?: NA

18. UNACCUSATIVITY

Are (at least some) reflexive-marked predicates syntactically unaccusative? yes

⁸ This example constitutes the only instance of *gawasjan* (15×) with a reflexive in the corpus.

(23) Reflexive in an equation, *puk silban*, John 10.33

...	<i>jah</i>	<i>patei</i>	<i>þu</i>	<i>manna</i>	<i>wisands</i>	<i>taujis</i>
...	and	because	2SG.NOM	man.NOM	be.PTCP.NPST.NOM	make.NPST.2SG
<i>puk</i>	<i>silban</i>	<i>du</i>	<i>guda</i>			
REFL.2SG.ACC	self.ACC	to	god.DAT			
‘and because you, being a man make yourself to (a) god’						

Just like simplex reflexives, complex reflexives do not admit of any further extension with a possessive pronoun or possessive adjective. Finally, it is further important to note that plausibly unaccusative verbs such as *gawasjan* ‘clothe (oneself)’ illustrated in (19) are compatible exclusively with the simplex *sik* construction; they are never attested with the complex *sik silba* construction. This distribution bolsters the conclusion that the *sik silba* construction builds a full DP and must occupy an argument position.

14. COORDINATION: yes

15. EQUATION: yes

16. MODIFICATION: no

17. OPTIONALITY OF MODIFICATION: NA

18. UNACCUSATIVITY: no

3.5 Expandability

3.5.1 Construction 1

Although the complex *sik silba* is to be regarded as a reflexive construction in its own right (on account of its transparent structure), and although *silba*- ‘self’ remains an independent lexeme in Gothic (not restricted to Construction 2), it is difficult to say whether some instances of the linear sequence of reflexive pronoun plus *silba*- immediately following a verb might properly constitute an expanded form of Construction 1, rather than Construction 2 proper. By default, I assume that all instances of REFL + *silba*- constitute instances of Construction 2, but do not categorically exclude that some might rather be interpreted as an expanded version of Construction 1 that is formally indistinguishable from Construction 2.

No further sort of expansion of the reflexive in either Construction 1 or Construction 2 is attested, whether with a specific reflexive pronoun, personal pronoun, or other anaphoric pronoun, nor is any iteration of the reflexive marker ever found (though (12) contains a unique erroneous repetition of the reflexive pronoun). Omission of the simplex reflexive marker when there are two conjoined reflexive verbs may perhaps be assumed on the basis of example (16) (repeated for convenience in (24) here), but this case is unique; there, the single reflexive pronoun *sik* must be read with both finite verbs, *afdomeiþ* and *gawargeiþ*, and as remarked upon above, this ap-

parent reduction of the reflexive pronoun might be responsible for its unusual linearization preceding the inflected verb. For want of any potentially positive evidence, it remains uncertain whether reduction of this sort involving the complex *sik silba* construction is possible (but see the discussion of (43) under 3.13 below).

- (24) *sik* precedes a conjoined pair of finite verbs, *afdomeip jah gawargeip* (cf. Miller 2019, p. 502), Bologna Fragment 2r.24-25

...	<i>akei</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>pammei</i>	<i>afaikip</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>pam-/-ma</i>
...	but	in	REL.DAT	deny.NPST.3SG	in	that.DAT
<i>sik</i>	<i>afdomeip</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>gawargeip</i>	<i>jabai</i>	<i>n=ist</i>	<i>G(u)p</i>
REFL.3.ACC	curse.NPST.	and	condemn.	if	NEG=be.	god.NOM
	3SG		NPST.3SG		NPST.3SG	

‘but in whomever he denies in that he curses and condemns himself if it is not god’

19. EXPANSION
Can the reflexive construction be expanded with an intensifier or a similar formant which is not a pronoun in itself for stress, clarification or similar ends? ?
20. DOUBLING WITH PRONOUNS
Can the reflexive marker be doubled with a distinct pronoun, be it reflexive, anaphoric or a personal pronoun? no
21. DOUBLING WITH REFLEXIVE
If doubling occurs, is the pronoun doubling the reflexive marker itself a reflexive? NA
22. DOUBLING WITH ANAPHORIC OR PERSONAL PRONOUN
If doubling occurs, is the pronoun doubling the reflexive marker a non-reflexive pronoun? NA
23. ADJACENCY
Is the reflexive obligatorily immediately adjacent to its expansion or to the doubled pronoun? yes
24. ITERATION
Can the reflexive marker be iterated within the same construction? no
25. REDUCIBILITY
Can the reflexive marker be omitted in conjuncts when preceded by the same construction? yes?

3.5.2 Construction 2

As discussed under 2, the complex *sik silba* construction (= Construction 2) transparently reflects, in origin, an expansion of the simplex *sik* construction (= Construction 1). However, the distributional differences between Construction 1 and Construction 2

are sufficiently well developed that complex *sik silba* should be regarded as a construction in its own right (see again the justification at 2). The complex *sik silba* construction, in turn, does not permit any expansion whatsoever, whether through a repetition of *silba*- ‘self’ or the addition of any other intensifier, nor may other distinct pronouns be added or the reflexive pronoun iterated.

It is worth mentioning in this context that the intensifier *silba*- ‘self’ in Construction 2 must agree with the reflexive pronoun in case and number (cf. 3.1.2), and virtually always exhibits masculine gender forms; one instance of neuter *sik silbo* occurs at Rom. 14.14. In contrast, when *silba*- is employed as an intensive predicate of identity appositional to a noun, agreement with the gender of the noun is regularly attested. When Construction 2 is employed, *silba*- almost exceptionlessly immediately follows the reflexive pronoun, and is always found adjacent to the reflexive marker. Compare examples (11) and (12) for such typical cases of REFL + *silba*-. Meanwhile, *silbans izwis* in (10) above shows one of the rare instances in which the linear order *silba*- + REFL is found; example (25) below, showing *silbans uns*, is the only other such case. Recall also that the expanded complex reflexive is also necessary in order to front a reflexive, i.e. to move it from the otherwise obligatory position immediately following the verb (cf. (17) and (18) above).

(25) Rare: *silba*- preceding pronoun, 1 Cor. 11.31

<i>ip</i>	<i>jabai</i>	<i>silbans</i>	<i>uns</i>	<i>stauideima,</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>pau</i>	[...]
for	if	self.ACC.PL	1PL.ACC	judge.NPST.OPT.1PL	not	as	

‘for if we would judge ourselves, not ...’ (Gothic text breaks off here)

Whether the complex *sik silba* construction can be reduced in a conjunct is simply unknown. While (16)/(24) provides marginal evidence for reducibility of the simplex construction, no parallel examples involving the complex construction exist.

- 19. EXPANSION: NO
- 20. DOUBLING WITH PRONOUNS: NO
- 21. DOUBLING WITH REFLEXIVE: NA
- 22. DOUBLING WITH ANAPHORIC OR PERSONAL PRONOUN: NA
- 23. ADJACENCY: NA
- 24. ITERATION: NO
- 25. REDUCIBILITY ?

3.6 Stress

3.6.1 Construction 1

The strong positional restrictions on simplex reflexives indicate that they are probably clitics and thus do not construct their own stress domains (whether or not they occupy

an argument role). That is, from the fact that a simplex reflexive like *sik* is virtually only found immediately following a verb or a preposition, and categorically never at the beginning of a clause, one may infer that such simplex reflexives are prosodically deficient and unable to build independent prosodic words, assuming that a prosodic word is the domain for the assignment of primary stress in Gothic.

26. STRESS Can the reflexive marker establish its own stress domain? no

3.6.2 Construction 2

Conversely, a full DP constructed by *silba-* ‘self’, and thus the complex *sik silba* construction, may be assumed to constitute an independent stress domain, in accord with the fact that it can be linearized differently from the simplex reflexive (see especially 2 and 3.2.2 above, and reference to further examples there). Since *silba-* is minimally disyllabic and, when employed as an intensifier outside of reflexive constructions, is not evidently subject to any positional restrictions, one may infer that it does constitute its own stress domain and is able to incorporate a reflexive pronoun.

26. STRESS Can the reflexive marker establish its own stress domain? yes

3.7 Phonological interaction

3.7.1 Construction 1

Clear evidence for segmental or prosodic effects conditioned by a reflexive in Gothic is difficult to find. Since primary stress in Gothic is assigned to initial syllables or the first syllable following a prefix in prefixed verbal forms (see generally Greiner 1994, Ch. 3 on evidence for the position of stress in Gothic), an enclitic reflexive pronoun would not be expected to produce any effect on primary stress. Segmental processes that can be inferred from surface alternations represented in the orthography of Gothic are also not abundant. One possibility concerns alternations affecting post-vocalic word final voiced stops: the segments /b, d, g/ are regularly subject to a process of spirantization, surfacing as [β, ð, γ] following a [–consonantal] segment (i.e. a vowel or the glide component of a diphthong), and these derived fricatives as well as the underlying fricative /z/ are subject to devoicing at the right edge of a prosodic word. Thus, the inflectional ending /-d/ of the NPST.3SG or NPST.2PL frequently surfaces as [θ] ⟨þ⟩. If the reflexive pronouns indeed constitute clitics that are incorporated into a prosodic word built by a verb, they might be expected to block the devoicing of word-final fricatives. Unfortunately, there are also good reasons to think that regressive voicing assimilation applied to sequences of obstruents, meaning that a sequence /Vds/ (in, e. g., /so:ki:-d=sik/ ‘seeks himself’) might nevertheless surface as [so:ki:θsik], showing spirantization of /d/ and regressive voicing assimilation. If spellings in Gothic manu-

scripts are to be taken at face value, inflectional endings with underlying /-d/ appear sometimes to surface as [ð], (e.g. *wopeid* ‘call.NPST.2PL’ preceding *mik* at John 13.13). Unfortunately, no neat phonological distribution on the spellings ⟨p⟩ vs. ⟨d⟩ at the end of morphological words can be readily established.¹⁰

27. INTERACTION Does the reflexive marker interact phonologically with surrounding linguistic items? no?

3.7.2 Construction 2

The considerations discussed immediately above apply equally to Construction 2. Indeed, insofar as Construction likely constitutes an independent DP with its own stress domain, phonological effects within the a prosodic word to which a clitic reflexive pronoun might belong, would be even more unexpected here. In the absence of any phonological processes known to be conditioned by the boundaries of or within phonological phrases, that *sik silba* exercises any phonological effects on linearly adjacent sequences will remain unknown.

27. INTERACTION no?

3.8 Homonymy

3.8.1 Construction 1

The Gothic reflexive pronouns are neither homonymous with lexemes that denote a body part, nor are they evidently restricted to some specialized subset of referents. The referents of reflexives are overwhelmingly of high animacy (i.e. human), but this fact is in part due to the nature of the corpus, and examples involving lower-animacy referents (i.e. animals) do occur, if rarely, as seen in (26), where the referent of the inherent reflexive verb *galisan sik* ‘gather together’ is *arans* ‘eagles’. Even abstract concepts such as *þiudangardi gudis* ‘the kingdom of god’ are admissible as subjects of a reflexive verb, as seen in (27). There is thus no particular reason to believe that use of reflexives was restricted to referents of with high animacy or any other particular semantic property.

¹⁰ Marchand 1973, pp. 49–50 counts 176 instances in the Gothic corpus where ⟨d⟩ is written word finally in a case where ⟨p⟩ is more common or should be expected, noting that “Sievers and Streitberg thought that these errors were caused by *f*, *þ*, *z* becoming voiced before words beginning in a voiced consonant or vowel.” Marchand rejects this view, favoring the explanation that the underlying phoneme could optionally be written instead of the surface allophone (“morphophonemic spelling”).

- (26) Non-human reflexive referent (animal), Luke 17.37

parei leik, jaindre galisand sik arans
 wherever body.NOM there gather.together.NPST.3SG REFL.3.ACC eagle.NOM.PL
 ‘Wherever the body (is), eagles will gather together’

- (27) Non-animate reflexive referent (abstract concept), Mark 1.15

qipands patei usfullnoda pata mel jah
 say.PTCP.NPST.NOM that be.filled.NPST.3SG the.NOM time.NOM and
atnehida sik piudangardi gudis
 approach.PST.3SG REFL.3.ACC kindgom.NOM god.GEN
 ‘(and he was) saying that the time is fulfilled and the kingdom of god has come near’

28. BODY PART HOMONYMY

Is the reflexive synchronically homonymous with a lexeme denoting a body part?
 no

29. SEMANTIC RESTRICTION

Is the use of the reflexive semantically restricted to a subset of referents? no

3.8.2 Construction 2

Although no examples comparable to (26) or (27) involving the complex *sik silba* construction are found, the otherwise parallel behavior of the simplex and complex reflexive constructions as direct reflexives leaves no convincing grounds for assuming that complex *sik silba* would have particular semantic restrictions either.

28. BODY PART HOMONYMY: no

29. SEMANTIC RESTRICTION: no

3.9 Use in deverbal derivation

3.9.1 Construction 1

Exactly one credible instance in the Gothic corpus of a reflexive construed with a denominal verb is known; it happens to employ Construction 2, but general similarities between Constructions 1 and 2 would suggest that simplex *sik* should also be grammatical in such cases. See immediately below.

30. DEVERBAL NOUNS

Can the marker occur with nominal derivatives? yes

31. OPTIONALITY WITH DEVERBAL NOUNS

If so, is the marker optional? yes

3.9.2 Construction 2

The example provided in (28), first observed by Rose 1976, pp. 86–89, provides sufficient evidence that reflexives could occur with denominal verbs. There, the noun *fraþjamarzeins* ‘deception’ governs the reflexive DP *sis silbin*. This deverbal noun is derived with a nominalizer *-ein-* (see Miller 2019, p. 342 on this derivational suffix) from an otherwise unattested verb *fraþjamarzjan** ‘deceive = irritate the mind’, itself evidently a compound verb built from *fraþi* ‘mind’ plus *marzjan* ‘irritate’. Since deverbal nouns built with *-ein-* or any other derivational suffixes evidently do not require use of a reflexive pronoun, the usage seen below must be optional. One may directly compare the nominalization *laiseins* ‘teaching, instruction’, which never occurs with a reflexive to generate the reading ‘learning’ parallel to the verb *(ga)laisjan sik* ‘learn’.

(28) Reflexive with denominal verb, Gal. 6.3

<i>iþ</i>	<i>jabai</i>	<i>þugkeiþ</i>	<i>has</i>	<i>ha</i>	<i>wisan,</i>	
for	if	think.NPST.	someone.	something.NOM	be.INF	
		3SG	NOM			
<i>ni</i>	<i>waiht</i>	<i>wisands,</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>silbin</i>	<i>fraþjamarzeins</i>	<i>ist.</i>
NEG	nothing	be.PTCP.NPST	REFL.3.DAT	self.DAT	deception.NOM	be.NPST.3SG
		.NOM				

‘for if someone think himself to be something when he is nothing, he deceives himself’

30. DEVERBAL NOUNS: yes

31. OPTIONALITY WITH DEVERBAL NOUNS: yes

3.10 Use with non-finite verb forms

3.10.1 Construction 1

The simplex reflexive *sik* readily occurs with infinitives and non-past participles, and is certainly obligatory when there is coreference between the subject of the matrix clause and the referent in the infinitive or participial clause;¹¹ when the subject of the matrix clause and the referent in the infinitive or participial clause differ, reflexives occur under the same conditions under which a reflexive would obligatorily occur with a finite form of the same verbal lexeme. Examples (29) and (30) showcase instances of a reflexive employed with an infinitive and a non-past participle, respectively,

¹¹ Note that the so-called “past passive participle” of Gothic is better regarded as a verbal noun than a non-finite verbal form; thus the lack of examples of reflexives with past passive participles in the corpus follows from the rarity of their occurrence with deverbal nouns (see 3.9 above).

in cases where coreference exists between the matrix subject and a referent in the non-finite clause. That a reflexive within a non-finite clause can refer to the subject of the main clause is parallel to the behavior of reflexives in e.g. Icelandic, where reflexive *sig* (cognate with Gothic *sik*) is obligatory, and contrasts with English or German, where a non-reflexive personal pronoun must instead be used (Harbert 2007, pp. 198–199; see also the chapters in this volume on North Germanic and Old West Germanic). The obligatoriness of the reflexive is also indicated by cases like (31), in which the non-past participle plus reflexive pronoun corresponds to an active, not middle, participle in the Greek (*embateúōn* ‘stepping in’) without any reflexive pronoun. Finally, in accord with the fact that the inflectional categories of the finite verb and reflexivity are not expressed cumulatively (cf. 3.2 above), reflexivity and non-finiteness are likewise not marked cumulatively in Gothic: the non-finite suffixes attach directly to the verbal stem, while the reflexive pronoun, as always, constitutes an independent morphological word.

- (29) Simplex reflexive in an infinitival clause, Luke 19.27

<i>þaiei_i</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>wildedun</i>	<i>mik</i>	<i>þiudanon</i>	<i>ufar</i>	<i>sis_i</i>
REL.NOM.PLNEG	want.PST.3PL	1SG.ACC	rule.INF	over		REFL.3.DAT

‘who_i did not want me to rule over them_i’

- (30) Simplex reflexive in a participial clause, Luke 6.32

<i>jah</i>	<i>auk</i>	<i>þai</i>	<i>frawaurhtans_i</i>	<i>þans_j</i>	<i>frijondans_j</i>	<i>sik_i</i>	<i>frijond_i</i>
and	also	the.	sinful.NOM.PL	that.ACC.PL	love.PTCP.NPST.	REFL.3.ACC	love.NPST.3PL
			NOM.PL		ACC.PL		

‘and also the sinners_i love those_j who_j love them_i’

- (31) Obligatory reflexive translating Greek active participle (*embateúōn*) without reflexive, Col. 2.18

<i>ni</i>	<i>hvašun</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>gajiukai,</i>	<i>wiljands</i>	
not	someone.NOM	2PL.ACC.	overcome.NPST.	want.PTCP.NPST.	
			OPT.3SG	NOM	
<i>in</i>	<i>hauneinai</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>blotinassau</i>	<i>aggile</i>	<i>þatei</i>
in	humility.DAT	and	worship.DAT	angel.GEN.PL	this.ACC
<i>ni</i>	<i>sah</i>	<i>ushaffands</i>	<i>sik</i>	...	
not	see.PST.3SG	raise.PTCP.NPST.NOM	REFL.3.ACC	...	

‘May no man overcome you, wanting in humility and worship of angels, intruding (lit. raising himself) into that which he has not seen...’

32. INFINITE VERB FORMS Does the marker co-occur with non-finite verb forms? yes

33. OPTIONALITY WITH NON-FINITE VERB FORMS

If so, is the marker optional? no

34. CUMULATIVITY IN NON-FINITE VERB FORMS

Can the marker express non-finiteness and reflexivity in a cumulative way? no

3.10.2 Construction 2

The complex *sik silba* construction, for its part, may also be employed as an argument of an infinitive (as in (32)) or a non-past participle (as in (33)), though the occurrence of Construction 2 in such contexts seems anecdotally to be relatively rarer than is the case for Construction 1. Importantly, however, the Construction 2 reflexive must always be bound by the subject of the infinitive or non-past participle: long-distance binding of the sort seen in (29) and (30) requires that the simplex *sik* construction be employed (see further 3.25 below).

(32) Complex reflexive in an infinitival clause, 2 Tim. 2.13

<i>jabai</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>galaubjam,</i>	<i>jains</i>	<i>triggws</i>	<i>wisip;</i>
if	NEG	believe.NPST.1PL	DEM.DIST.NOM	faithful.NOM	remain.NPST.3SG
<i>afaikan</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>silban</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>mag</i>	
deny.INF	REFL.3.ACC	self.ACC	believe.NPST.3SG		
‘if we do not believe (in him), he will remain faithful; he cannot deny himself’					

(33) Complex reflexive in a participial clause, Gal. 2.20

<i>apban</i>	<i>patei</i>	<i>nu</i>	<i>liba</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>leika,</i>	<i>in</i>
however	that	now	live.NPST.1SG	in	body.DAT	in
<i>galaubeinai</i>	<i>liba</i>	<i>sunus</i>	<i>gudis,</i>	<i>þis</i>	<i>frijondins</i>	<i>mik</i>
belief.DAT	live.NPST.1SG	son.GEN	god.GEN	DEM.3SG.	love.PTCP.NPST.	1SG.ACC
				GEN	GEN	
<i>jah</i>	<i>atgibandins</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>silban</i>	<i>faur</i>	<i>mik</i>	
and	give.up.PTCP.	REFL.3.ACC	self.ACC	for	1SG.ACC	
	NPST.GEN					

‘that I however now live in in the flesh, I live in belief of the son of god, who loved me and gave himself up on my behalf’

32. INFINITE VERB FORMS: yes

33. OPTIONALITY WITH NON-FINITE VERB FORMS: no

34. CUMULATIVITY IN NON-FINITE VERB FORMS: no

3.11 Direct reflexive semantics

3.11.1 Construction 1

Direct reflexives in Gothic are very common: a reflexive pronoun in either Construction 1 or Construction 2 (though Construction 2 seems to be statistically preferred in the 1st or 2nd person; see 2 above) may be coreferential with the subject of a prototypically transitive verb. Example (34), repeated from above, shows a direct reflexive with the verb *bliggwan* ‘beat, harm’ in its participial form.

(34) Direct reflexive (simplex *sik* construction): *bliggwan* ‘beat, harm’ with *sik*, Mark 5.5

<i>jah</i>	<i>sinteino</i>	<i>nahtam</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>dagam</i>	<i>in</i>
and	always	night.DAT.PL	and	day.DAT.PL	in
<i>aurahjom</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>fairgunjam</i>	<i>was</i>	<i>hropjands</i>
tomb.DAT.PL	and	in	mountain.DAT.PL	be.PST.3SG	cry.PTCP.NPST.NOM
<i>jah</i>	<i>bliggwands</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>stainam</i>		
and	beat.PTCP.	REFL.3.ACC	stone.DAT.PL		
	NPST.NOM				

‘and always, night and day, he was in the tombs and in the mountains, crying and beating himself with stones’

(Greek *katakóptōn heautōn* ‘cutting himself’)

Compare further the list of cases where the Greek has an active verb with reflexive pronoun rendered similarly with a reflexive pronoun in Gothic in Ferraresi 2005, pp. 87–88 (e.g., *ataugjan* ‘show’, *fragan* ‘ask’, *haunjan* ‘humble, abase’); in virtually all cases, a prototypically transitive use of the verb, with non-referential subject and direct object, may be found in the corpus.

35. DIRECT REFLEXIVE SEMANTICS

Is the construction used to denote events with direct reflexive argument structure? yes

3.11.2 Construction 2

Example (35) illustrates a typical direct reflexive with a finite form of *ussokjan* ‘examine, judge’, where its subject is coreferential with the direct object *mik silban*. Again, particularly when the subject is in the first or second person, a preference for Construction 2 seems detectable.

- (35) Direct reflexive (complex *sik silba* construction): *ussokjan* ‘examine, judge’ with *mik silban*, 1 Cor. 4.3

<i>akei</i>	<i>nih</i>	<i>mik_i</i>	<i>silban</i>	<i>ussokja_i</i>
but	not	REFL.1SG.ACC	self.ACC	judge.NPST.1SG
‘but I do not judge my own self’				

35. DIRECT REFLEXIVE SEMANTICS: yes

3.12 Indirect reflexive semantics

3.12.1 Construction 1

While not as abundantly and unambiguously attested as direct reflexives, a handful of instances of likely indirect reflexives, with coreference between an agent and beneficiary, do occur in the Gothic corpus. For instance, ‘borrow’ is expressed in Gothic through the transitive verb *leihvan* ‘lend’ plus a reflexive pronoun in its dative form, as shown in example (36). More generally, in many instances in which a transitive verb, such as *bugjan* ‘buy’, or a denominal verb containing the underlying noun as a theme, such as *frawaurkjan* ‘commit a sin’, is construed with a reflexive pronoun in the dative, an indirect reflexive construction is likely at hand. Examples (37) and (38) represent the former type, while (39) illustrates the latter (compare also Matt. 27.4 for another instance of *frawaurhta mis*).

- (36) ‘borrow’ = ‘lend for oneself’, Matt. 5.42

<i>pamma</i>	<i>bidjandin</i>	<i>puk</i>	<i>gibais,</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>pamma</i>
3SG.M.DAT	ask.PTCP.NPST.DAT	2SG.ACC	give.NPST.OPT.2SG	and	3.SG.DAT
<i>wiljandin</i>	<i>af</i>	<i>pus</i>	<i>leihvan</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>ni</i>
want.PTCP.NPST.DAT	from	2SG.DAT	lend.INF	REFL.3.DAT	NEG
<i>uswandjais</i>					
turn.away.NPST.OPT.2SG					
‘may you give to him who asks and not turn away from him who wants to borrow from you’					

- (37) ‘buy food for themselves (for their own benefit)’, Luke 9.12

<i>fralet</i>	<i>bo</i>	<i>managein,</i>	<i>ei</i>	<i>galeipandans</i>	
let.go.NPST.	the.ACC	crowd.ACC	3PL.NOM	go.off.PTCP.NPST.	
IMP.2SG				NOM.PL	
<i>in</i>	<i>pos</i>	<i>bisunjane</i>	<i>haimos</i>	<i>jah</i>	
in	DET.ACC.PL	all.around	countryside.	and	
			ACC.PL		
<i>weihsa</i>	<i>saljaina</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>bugjaina</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>matins</i>
village.ACC.PL	lodge.NPST.	and	buy.NPST.OPT.3PL	REFL.3.DAT	food.ACC.PL
	OPT.3PL				

‘let the crowd go, that they may go off into the countryside and the villages all around and find lodging and buy food for themselves’

- (38) ‘make a run for it (for their own perceived benefit)’, Matt. 8.32

<i>jah</i>	<i>sai,</i>	<i>run</i>	<i>gawaurhtedun</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>alla</i>	<i>so</i>
and	behold	run.ACC	do.PST.3PL	REFL.3.DAT	all.NOM	the.NOM
<i>hairda</i>	<i>and</i>	<i>driuson</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>marein</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>gadaupnodedun</i>
herd.NOM	over	cliff.ACC	in	sea.ACC	and	die.PST.3PL
<i>in</i>	<i>watnam</i>					
in	water.DAT.PL					

‘and behold, the whole herd [of swine] made a run for it, over a cliff into the sea and perished in the waters’

- (39) Indirect reflexive of disadvantage (simplex
- sik*
-), Luke 15.18

<i>atta,</i>	<i>frawaurhta</i>	<i>mis</i>	<i>in himin</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>in andwairbja</i>	<i>peinamma</i>
father.VOC	sin.PST.1SG	1SG.DAT	in heaven.ACC	and	in presence.DAT	POSS.2SG.DAT

‘father, I have sinned against heaven and in your presence’

Note that all of the examples given immediately above involve the simplex *sik* construction.

36. INDIRECT REFLEXIVE

Is the construction used to denote events in which the beneficiary and agent are coreferent? yes

3.12.2 Construction 2

Clear instances of indirect reflexives using Construction 2 are, in contrast with Construction 1, rare to nonexistent: certainly no examples in the first or second persons are present in the corpus, and some instances of dative *sis silbin* outside of a prepositional phrase involve a verb that can mark a direct object exceptionally with the da-

tive, rather than the accusative (*usqiman* ‘kill’, *fraqistjan* ‘spoil, kill’, *frapjamarzjan** ‘deceive’; see (28) for the single instance of the latter). Example (40) thus appears to be the most secure example of an indirect reflexive involving the complex *sik silba* construction.

(40) Indirect reflexive of disadvantage (complex *sik silba*), 1 Cor. 11.29

<i>saei</i>	<i>auk</i>	<i>matjiþ</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>drigkiþ</i>	<i>unwairþaba,</i>	<i>staua</i>
REL.NOM	for	eat.NPST.	and	drink.NPST.	unworthily	final.judgment.ACC
		3SG		3SG		
<i>sis</i>	<i>silbin</i>	<i>matjiþ</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>drigkiþ,</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>domjands</i>
REFL.3.DAT	self.DAT	eat.NPST.	and	drink.NPST.	NEG	judge.PTCP.NPST.NOM
		3SG		3SG		
<i>leik</i>	<i>fraujins</i>					
body.ACC	lord.GEN					

‘for he who eats and drinks unworthily eats and drinks damnation unto himself, not distinguishing the body of the lord’

36. INDIRECT REFLEXIVE: yes

3.13 Equivalence set with reciprocals

3.13.1 Construction 1

The reflexive pronoun is an integral part of reciprocal constructions in Gothic. However, in such cases, the reflexive pronoun alone is insufficient for a reciprocal reading, being obligatory extended by the indeclinable adverb *misso* ‘each other’. At the same time, *misso* is wholly dependent upon a reflexive pronoun, never once (among its 65 tokens in the corpus) occurring without an adjacent reflexive pronoun; like *silba* ‘self’, it nearly always follows the reflexive pronoun in its dative case (one exception, *misso izwis*, occurs at John 13.34). Two typical instances of a reciprocal construction involving a transitive verb, *þwahan* ‘wash’ and *andstandan* ‘stand against, resist’, are illustrated in (41) and (42).

(41) 2PL person reciprocal, John 13.14

<i>jah</i>	<i>jus</i>	<i>skuluþ</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>misso</i>	<i>þwahan</i>	<i>fotuns</i>
and	2PL.NOM	shall.NPST.2PL	2PL.DAT	each.other	wash.INF	foot.ACC.PL

‘and you ought to wash one another’s feet’

(42) 3rd person reciprocal, Gal. 5.17

... *ip* *ahma* *wipra* *leik*, *þo* *nu* *sis*
 ... and spirit.NOM against body.ACC this.NOM.PL now REFL.3.DAT
misso *andstandand*
 each.other stand.against.
 NPST.3PL

‘...and the spirit against the flesh, and these are contrary to one another’

37. RECIPROCAL

Does the construction form an equivalence set with reciprocals? yes

3.13.2 Construction 2

Crucially, complex *sik silba* does not appear to lend itself to combination with *misso*: a linearization ^x*sis misso silbin* or ^x*sis silbin misso* is likely ungrammatical. Example (43), however, presents a unique and peculiar case, in which two conjoined verbs must be understood with reciprocals, though only the argument of the first verb presents the typical reflexive construction (*izwis misso*), the second governing a form of *silba*- alone, without reflexive pronoun. Such a conjoined reciprocal construction is found nowhere else in the corpus, and evidently results from an attempt to render the Greek *anekhómenoi allélōn kai kharidzómenoi heautoīs* ‘sustaining each other and forgiving one another’. Note that Greek *allélōn* ‘each other’ is consistently rendered with a Gothic reflexive pronoun plus *misso*; Greek *heautoīs* ‘REFL.3.DAT.PL’ is occasionally used instead of *allélōn*, and in at least one instance in the biblical corpus (Eph. 4.32), *heautoīs* is used as a reciprocal, rendered in Gothic as *izwis misso* ‘2PL.DAT each.other’. Exactly what to conclude from (43) is unclear; one possibility is that *fagibandans silbans* reflects a reduced instance of *sik silbans* (the reducibility of reflexive pronouns in conjunction being supported by (24)), which might in turn indicate that REFL + *silba*- may sometimes constitute an expansion of Construction 1 rather than an employ of Construction 2.

(43) Reduction of complex *sik silba* in a reciprocal construction, Col. 3.13

þulandans *izwis* *misso* *jah* *fragibandans* *silbans*
 ...tolerate.PTCP. REFL.2PL.DAT each.other and forgive.PTCP.NPST.NOM.PL self.ACC.PL ...
 NPST.NOM.PL

‘tolerating each other and forgiving each other ...’

37. RECIPROCAL no?

3.14 Equivalence set with passives

3.14.1 Construction 1

In general, the Gothic reflexive constructions seem to be excluded from interpretation as passives. The absence of unambiguous passives built through a reflexive construction may, however, be due to the abundance of other dedicated passive constructions available in Gothic: besides the morphologically synthetic passive (see 2 above), Gothic also possesses a periphrastic passive built with *wairþan* ‘become’ or *wisan* ‘be’ plus a past passive participle (for an overview, see Miller 2019, pp. 215–220). One possible instance in which a reflexive construction might express a passive involves the verb *inmaidjan* ‘transform’ which is attested twice as a synthetic passive (*inmaidjanda* ‘are transformed’) and once with a reflexive, where it translates a Greek passive aorist (*metemorphóthē* ‘he was transformed’), shown in (44). Since the passive sense ‘he was transformed’ and the direct reflexive sense ‘he transformed himself’ are pragmatically similar, it is conceivable that the Gothic translator opted to render a past tense passive inexactly as a reflexive, since the synthetic passive has only non-past forms; why the translator did not attempt to employ a periphrastic passive in this case is unclear.¹²

(44) Passive reflexive?, Mark 9.2

jah inmaidida sik in andwairþja ize
 and transform.PST.3SG REFL.3.ACC in presence.DAT 3.GEN.PL
 ‘and he was transformed (/ transformed himself) before them’

38. PASSIVE

Does the construction form and equivalence set with passives? no?

3.14.2 Construction 2

If evidence for passive interpretations involving Construction 1 is rare and ambiguous at best, credible passive readings involving Construction 2 are wholly absent. That passives could not be construed with complex *sik silba* therefore seems likely.

38. PASSIVE: NO

¹² *inmaidjan* ‘transform’ is also once attested with a past tense periphrastic passive, namely *inmaidips* was ‘was transformed’ (Skeireins 3.5).

3.15 Equivalence set with facilitatives

The Gothic corpus presents no evidence that either of the two reflexive constructions considered here were employed for the expression of facilitatives.

3.15.1 Construction 1

39. FACILITATIVE Is the construction used in contexts where ease of execution is stressed? no

40. FACILITATIVE-IMPERSONAL

If so, is the construction used in impersonals? NA

3.15.2 Construction 2

39. FACILITATIVE: no

40. FACILITATIVE-IMPERSONAL: NA

3.16 Equivalence set with impersonal constructions

No cases are attested in the Gothic corpus of a reflexive construction used for the expression of an impersonal.

3.16.1 Construction 1

41. IMPERSONAL

Does the construction form and equivalence set with impersonal constructions?
no

3.16.2 Construction 2

41. IMPERSONAL: no

3.17 Equivalence set with anticausatives

3.17.1 Construction 1

Reflexives occur on a small number of oppositional anticausatives in Gothic, though anticausative valency changing operations are more commonly expressed through the derivation of Class IV weak verbs (*-nan-* verbs). For more details on anticausatives built with reflexives, see Miller 2019, pp. 394–396 and Ottosson 2013, pp. 348–349; on the class of *-nan-*verbs as the usual means of building oppositional anticausatives, see Ferraresi 2005, pp. 111–121 and Katz 2016, Ch. 2–5. Examples (45) and (46) both constitute cases in which a transitive verb, *blandan* ‘mix’ and *galaisjan* ‘teach’ respectively, is employed with a simple reflexive, and the agent (the source of mixing or teaching) is not expressed whatsoever, while the subject of the verb is an undergoer of the event expressed by the verb (being caused to be mixed or caused to learn).

(45) *blandan sik* ‘mingle’ (< *blandan* ‘mix’), 2 Thess. 3.14

ni blandaip izwis miþ imma, ei gaskamai sik
 NEG mix.NPST.OPT.2PL 2PL.ACC with 3SG.M.DAT that shame.NPST.OPT.3SG REFL.3.ACC
 ‘do not mingle with him, that he may be ashamed’

(46) *galaisjan sik* ‘learn’ (< *galaisjan* ‘teach’), Phil. 4.11

ik galaisida mik in þaimei im ganohiþs wisan
 1SG.NOM teach.PST.1SG 1SG.ACC in REL.DAT.PL be.NPST.1SG content.NOM be.INF
 ‘I learned to be content in whatever (circumstances) I am (in)’

As Miller 2019, pp. 395–396 further observes, the monovalency of these oppositional anticausatives is motivated by two further facts: 1) in (46), the adjective *ganohiþs* ‘content.NOM’ does not agree in case with *mik*, which shows that nominative *ik*, not *mik*, exercises control over the subject of the infinitive; 2) when an oppositional anticausative occurs in a participial or infinitival clause, the simplex reflexive pronoun is not bound by the subject of the matrix clause, which demonstrates that the reflexive in such cases cannot be an anaphor (see 3.25 below).

Evidence for non-oppositional anticausatives denoting spontaneous events appears to be lacking in Gothic. A handful of verbs that are attested with reflexives would fit the expected semantic profile, e.g. *gabairhtjan* ‘reveal, appear’; but in virtually all such cases, the verb can be shown to be transitive, taking two arguments (e.g. *gabairhtja imma mik silban* at John 14.21 contains a complex reflexive, which must occupy a theta-role). The example shown in (47) contains the verb *afgiban sik* ‘depart’, which might be understood as denoting a spontaneous event; but since it is attested only in this passage, and since the base verb *giban* is transitive, an oppositional anticausative (< *afgiban** ‘give away, send away’) cannot be excluded. Meanwhile, *gagalei-kon sik* ‘transform oneself, appear similar to’ is indeed most plausibly understood as a

spontaneous anticausative; it is neither demonstrably oppositional nor polyvalent, occurring three times in the corpus and always with a simplex reflexive, as in example (48) (note there that *silba* is not part of the reflexive, but rather an intensifier). Ultimately, the available data does not permit a firm conclusion, but it would on balance be safer to assume that non-oppositional anticausatives are not expressed through the reflexive construction.

(47) *afgiban sik* ‘depart’ (spontaneous or oppositional?), Phil. 1.15

aufto auk dupe afgaf sik du heilai
 perhaps for therefore depart.PST.3SG REFL.3.ACC to period.of.time.DAT
 ‘for perhaps he therefore departed for a season’

(48) *gagaleikon sik* ‘transform oneself’ (possibly spontaneous), 2 Cor. 11.14

... *unte silba Satana gagaleikop sik aggil[l]au liuhadis*
 ... for self.NOM S.NOM transform.NPST.3SG REFL.3.ACC angel.DAT light.GEN
 ‘...for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light’

42. ANTICAUSATIVE

Does the construction form and equivalence set with oppositional anticausatives?
 yes

43. SPONTANEOUS EVENT

Is the construction used on non-oppositional anticausatives to denote spontaneous events? no?

3.17.2 Construction 2

Note that the apparent oppositional anticausatives as in (45) and (46) occur exclusively with simplex reflexives (*blandan sik* 3×, *galaisjan sik* 6×), never with the complex reflexive construction built with *silba*-. This fact suggests that the reflexive pronoun does not correspond to an additional argument role (i.e. the oppositional anticausatives are monovalent); since the complex *sik silba* construction, by contrast, does occupy an argument role, its usage in forming an oppositional anticausative is ruled out.

42. ANTICAUSATIVE: NO

43. SPONTANEOUS EVENT: NA

3.18 Equivalence set with antipassives

Gothic presents no evidence for the use of its reflexive constructions in forming antipassives, whether as a strict patient-backgrounding operation or in the expression of habitual activities.

3.18.1 Construction 1

44. ANTIPASSIVE

Does the construction form and equivalence set with antipassive constructions?

no

3.18.2 Construction 2

44. ANTIPASSIVE: NO

3.19 Further semantic restrictions on constructions

Gothic attests numerous reflexive verbs that cover practically the full range of canonical middle semantics (see Kemmer 1993, Kemmer 1994, and for Gothic specifically, Ferraresi 2005, pp. 98–99). Compare the (non-comprehensive) list of Gothic reflexive verbs translating Greek mediopassives in Ferraresi 2005, pp. 89–90, which largely belong to the semantic domains discussed here. Crucially, just as with the expression of anticausatives, only the simplex *sik* construction is permitted in the expression of any middle functions; complex *sik silba* is never employed with any of the specific verbs discussed below.

3.19.1 Construction 1

Several distinct verbs of grooming occur in reflexive constructions, exhibiting somewhat different profiles. *gahamon* ‘dress oneself with, put on oneself’ (5×) is not a transitive verb, since the thing being put on is usually expressed in the dative, and is more often attested without a reflexive (3×).¹³ Of the two instances where a reflexive is employed with *gahamon*, one case involves a concrete article of clothing (see example (49)), and one does not (Col. 3.12); contrast (49) with (50), where the latter has no accompanying reflexive. Under the usual interpretation applied to *andhamon sik* ‘undress (oneself)’ in its single occurrence (see (14) above), its syntax may be assumed to be parallel to that of *gahamon*.

¹³ The valency of *gahamon* and its syntax thus contrast with the Greek *endúō* ‘go into; put on, clothe’, which *gahamon* consistently translates, as the Greek verb takes an accusative object.

- (49)
- gahamon*
- ‘dress, put on’ with reflexive, Eph. 6.11

gahamop izwis sarwam gudis ...
 dress.NPST.IMP.2PL REFL.2PL.ACC/DAT weapon/armor.DAT.PL god.GEN ...
 ‘dress yourselves with the armor of god’

- (50)
- gahamon*
- ‘dress, put on’ without reflexive, Eph. 4.24

jah gahamop pamma niujin mann ...
 and dress.NPST.2PL DET.M.DAT new.DAT man.DAT ...
 ‘and you dress yourselves with the new man’

The verb *gawasjan* ‘clothe (oneself)’ (14×, including past passive participles), on the other hand, is transitive, and may take as an accusative the person being clothed, if distinct from the subject, or else occur either with (as in (51); see also (19b) above) or without (as in (52)) a reflexive pronoun; whenever the thing with which a person is to be clothed is expressed, it occurs as a dative.

- (51)
- gawasjan*
- ‘clothe (oneself)’ with reflexive, Matt. 6.29

... *ni=h Saulaumon in allamma wulþau seinamma*
 ... not=and S.NOM in all.DAT glory.DAT POSS.REFL.3.DAT
gawasida sik swe ains þize
 clothe.PST.3SG REFL.3.ACC like one DET.GEN.PL
 ‘...and not even Solomon in all his glory clothed himself like one of them’

- (52)
- gawasjan*
- ‘clothe (oneself)’ without reflexive, Rom. 13.12

uswairpam nu waurstwam riqizis, ip gawajam
 throw.off.NPST.1PL now work.DAT.PL darkness.GEN and clothe.NPST.1PL
sarwam liuhadis
 weapon/armor.DAT.PL light.GEN
 ‘let us now cast off the works of darkness and clothe ourselves with the armor of light’

As the above examples show, particular verbs of grooming, depending upon their inherent valency, exhibit different readings in the presence of reflexive constructions. When the verb is intransitive, as in the case of *gahamon*, the same reading obtains with and without the reflexive: the reflexive is certainly optional, not oppositional, and is not systematically employed redundantly. When the verb is transitive, as in the case of *gawasjan*, a direct reflexive reading obtains, with subject and object being co-extensive; although oppositional, the reflexive appears to be optional, not occurring in every such instance.

A number of verbs of nontranslational motion are found with reflexives in Gothic, including *ufþanjan* ‘stretch’, *gawandjan* ‘turn, return’, and *blandan* ‘mix with’ (see (45) above); *ufarhaffjan* ‘exalt’ might be understood as another such case, though the sense

is metaphorical, not involving literal motion in its single attested example (2 Thess. 2.4). Both instances of *ufpanjan* ‘stretch’, shown in (53) and (54) occur with a reflexive, suggesting that the reflexive in this case is redundant, not oppositional; much the same applies to *blandan*, which always occurs with a reflexive except when in the infinitive. In contrast, the frequent *gawandjan* (35×) rather resembles *gawasjan* ‘clothe (oneself)’: the verb is transitive and thus builds an oppositional reflexive, and although the reflexive pronoun usually occurs when no other direct object is at hand, a few instances lack the reflexive pronoun without obvious differences in sense (i.e. one cannot straightforwardly distinguish a non-reflexive *gawandjan* and an inherently reflexive *gawandjan sik*); contrast (55) with (56) below. Therefore, the reflexive would appear to be redundant for at least some verbs of nontranslational motion (*gawandjan*), and given that other relevant verbs are not frequently attested (*ufpanjan*, *blandan*, *ufarhafjan*), it may be accidental that they are attested only with a reflexive.

(53) *ufpanjan* ‘stretch’, 2 Cor. 10.14

<i>ni</i>	<i>auk</i>	<i>[sweswe</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>fairrinnandans</i>	<i>und</i>	<i>izwis]</i>
not	for	like	not	reach.PTCP.NPST.NOM	to/towards	2.PL.DAT
<i>ufarassau</i>	<i>ufpanjam</i>	<i>uns</i>	...			
excess.DAT	stretch.NPST.1PL	REFL.1PL.ACC	...			

‘for we do not stretch ourselves excessively, [as through we were not reaching towards you]...’

(54) *ufpanjan* ‘stretch’, Phil. 3.14

<i>apþan</i>	<i>ain</i>	<i>sweþauh</i>	<i>þaim</i>	<i>afta</i>	<i>ufarmunnonds,</i>	<i>ip</i>	<i>du</i>
however	one.ACC	indeed	DET.DAT.PL	back	forget.PTCP.NPST.	but	to
					NOM		
<i>þaim</i>	<i>þoei</i>	<i>faura</i>	<i>sind,</i>	<i>mik</i>	<i>ufpanjands</i>	...	
DET.DAT.PL	REL.NOM.PL	before	be.NPST.3.PL	REFL.1SG.ACC	stretch.PTCP.NPST.	...	
					NOM		

‘however, indeed (I do) one thing, forgetting those things that are behind, but stretching myself towards those things that are in front ...’

(55) *gawandjan* ‘turn, return’ with reflexive, Luke 8.40

<i>warþ</i>	<i>þan</i>	<i>mipþanei</i>	<i>gawandida</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>Iesus,</i>
become.PST.3SG	then	when	return.PST.3SG	REFL.3.ACC	J.NOM
<i>andnam</i>	<i>ina</i>	<i>managei</i>			
receive.PST.3SG	3SG.M.ACC	crowd.NOM			

and it then came to pass, when Jesus returned, the crowd received him’

- (56)
- gawandjan*
- ‘turn, return’ without reflexive, Luke 8.55

jah gawandida ahman izos, jah ustop suns
 and return.PST.3PL spirit.NOM 3SG.F.GEN and arise.PST.3SG suddenly
 ‘and the her spirit returned and she arose immediately’

Reflexive constructions with verbs expressing changes of body posture, meanwhile, appear to be absent in Gothic. Some of the most common such verbs (e.g. *usstandan* ‘rise, rise up’, *urrisan* ‘arise’, *ligan* ‘lie’, and *gasitan* ‘sit down’) all behave straightforwardly as intransitives, never occurring with a reflexive pronoun. No verbs pertaining to this semantic field appear in the lists given in Ferraresi 2005, nor did any emerge in a comprehensive survey of first person reflexives.

Several examples of the simplex *sik* reflexive construction involving verbs of translational motion are available for Gothic. Relevant verbs include *galisan* ‘gather’ (see (26) above), *afgiban* ‘depart’ (see (47) above), *gagaggan* ‘go away’, *atnehan* ‘draw close to, come close’, *gaqemun* ‘gather’, and *gaskaidan* ‘withdraw, retire’; the first of these verbs is certainly, and the second may be, an oppositional anticausative. *gagaggan* in its profile is similar to *gahamon* ‘dress oneself with’, in that may occur both as an intransitive without a reflexive (shown in (58), with suppletive past tense stem *gaiddj-*) or with a reflexive pronoun (shown in (57)). *atnehan* likewise exhibits this behavior: essentially identical passages are found at Luke 10.9 and 10.11, both rendering Greek *éggiken*, with and without reflexive *sik*. One further interesting case involves the single occurrence of the verb (*ga*)*dragan*,¹⁴ shown in (59), where, contrary to other reflexive constructions involving motion, the reflexive occurs in the dative and the verb additionally takes an accusative argument (*laisarjans* ‘teachers’).

- (57)
- gagaggan*
- ‘go away’ with reflexive, 1 Cor. 5.4

... *samaþ* *gagaggandam* *izwis* ... *miþ* *mahtai*
 ... together go.away.PTCP.NPST.DAT.PL REFL.2PL.DAT ... with power.DAT
fraujins unsaris Iesus *Xristaus*
 lord.GEN POSS.1PL.GEN J.GEN C.GEN
 ‘...(when) you go away together ...with the power of our lord Jesus Christ’

- (58)
- gagaggan*
- ‘go away’ without reflexive, John 18.2

patei ufta gaiddja Iesus jainar miþ siponjam seinaim
 that often go.away.PST.3SG J.NOM there with disciple.DAT.PL POSS.REFL.3.DAT.PL
 ‘for Jesus often went off there with his disciples’

¹⁴ The Codex Ambrosianus A contains *gadragan*, while the same passage in the Ambrosianus B contains *dragan*. Given that reflexives with middle semantics are more typical of verbs prefixed with *ga-*, Streithberg 1910, p. 26 takes *dragan* in B to be erroneous.

(59) *gadragan sis* ‘drag themselves’, 2 Tim. 4.3

...	<i>ak</i>	<i>du</i>	<i>seinaim</i>	<i>lustum</i>
...	but	to	POSS.REFL.3.DAT.PL	desire.DAT.PL
<i>gadragand</i>	<i>sis</i>	<i>laisarjans,</i>	<i>subjandans</i>	<i>hausein</i>
drag.NPST.3PL	REFL.3.DAT	teacher.ACC.PL	itch.PTCP.NPST.NOM.PL	ear.ACC

‘but according to their own desires they will drag themselves towards teachers, having itching ears’

The simplex reflexive construction also occurs with a variety of verbs of cognition in Gothic, including *þagkjan* ‘think, reason’, *andþagkjan* ‘be resolved, intend’, *miton* ‘consider, reason’ (1× with reflexive, Mark 2.8), *munan* ‘believe, suppose’ (1× with reflexive, Phil. 1.17), and *gamaudjan* ‘remember’. As with other verbs with middle semantics in Gothic, the reflexive appears to be optional; compare the nearly identical constructions in (60) and (61), which differ primarily in the presence versus absence of the reflexive pronoun. Note that where no reflexive occurs in the Gothic, the Greek has an active aorist participle (*sumbállousa* ‘reckoned’), but where there is a reflexive in the Gothic, the Greek has a middle participle; the choice of whether or not to employ a reflexive construction, in cases where the reflexive was optional in the first place, may thus have been influenced by the Greek model. As seen in the examples there, reflexive constructions involving verbs of cognition, as well as the further categories treated below, distinguish themselves from the categories of grooming and motion discussed above in that they may employ the reflexive either in the dative (*þagkjan* and *miton*) or accusative (*munan* and *andþagkjan*, illustrated in (62)). With verbs of cognition, the reflexive is neither oppositional nor does it consistently occur throughout the paradigm (i.e. it is redundant).

(60) *þagkjan* ‘think reason’ with reflexive, Mark 2.6

<i>wesun=uh</i>	<i>þan</i>	<i>sumai</i>	<i>þize</i>	<i>bokarje</i>
be.PST.3PL=and	then	some.NOM.PL	DET.M.GEN.PL	scribe.GEN.PL
<i>jainar</i>	<i>sitandans</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>þagkjandans</i>	<i>sis</i>
there	sit.PTCP.NPST.	and	think.PTCP.NPST.	REFL.3.DAT
	NOM.PL		NOM.PL	
<i>in</i>	<i>hairtam</i>	<i>seinaim</i>		
in	heart.DAT.PL	POSS.REFL.3.DAT.PL		

‘and there were some of the scribes sitting there, and reasoning in their hearts’

- (61)
- pagkjan*
- ‘think, reason’ without reflexive, Luke 2.19

iþ Maria alla gafastaida þo waurda, þagkjandei
 but M. all.N.ACC.PL keep.PST.3SG DET.N.ACC.PL word.ACC.PL think.PTCP.NPST.
 NOM.PL

in hairtin seinamma
 in heart.DAT POSS.REFL.3.DAT

‘but Mary kept all these words, considering (them) in her heart’

- (62)
- andþagkjan*
- ‘be resolved, intend’, Luke 16.4

andþahta mik hva taujau, ei
 intend.PST.1SG REFL.1SG.ACC what.ACC do.NPST.OPT.1SG that
þan, biþe afsatjaidau us fauragaggja,
 then when dismiss.NPST.OPT. PASS.1SG from stewardship.DAT

andnimaina mik in gardins seinans
 take.NPST.OPT.3PL 1SG.ACC in home.ACC.PL POSS.REFL.3.ACC.PL

‘I am resolved (as to) what I will do, so that, when I may be dismissed from the stewardship, they may take me into their homes’

Reflexive constructions with several distinct verbs of emotion are likewise well-attested in Gothic. Here, the verb *skaman sik* ‘be ashamed’, shown in (7) under 3.1, is notable for the fact that the reflexive is evidently fully obligatory: each of the ten instances of this verb in the corpus occurs with a simplex reflexive in the accusative (*mik*, *þuk*, *sik*, or *uns*). The verb *ogan** ‘fear, be afraid’, on the other hand, does not obligatorily employ a reflexive (only 11 of 46 tokens of the verb), which appears in the dative since the verb may also take a direct object in the accusative, as illustrated in (63); the (simplex) reflexive is thus optional with this verb. Also belonging to this semantic category is *idreigon* ‘repent, feel regret’, where the reflexive is likewise non-obligatory.¹⁵

- (63)
- ogan sis*
- ‘fear’, Mark 6.20

unte Herodis ohta sis Iohannen, kunnands
 for H.NOM fear.PST.3SG REFL.3.DAT J.ACC know.PTCP.NPST.NOM
ina wair garaihtana jah weihana
 3SG.M.ACC man.ACC just.ACC and holy.ACC

‘for Herod feared John, knowing him (as a) just and holy man’

¹⁵ Instances of the verb *þrafstjan* ‘comfort, console’, which frequently occur in the imperative with a reflexive, e.g. *þrafstei þuk* ‘take comfort!’, are in fact simple direct reflexives, i.e. to be read as ‘comfort yourself’; the verb is transitive, i.e. ‘comfort someone’.

Neither inherent nor oppositional reflexives occur with speech act verbs, whether emotive or not, in Gothic. One instance of the verb *rodjan* ‘speak’ occurs with a dative reflexive *sis* at Luke 7.39, but functioning merely as an indirect object (without benefactive reading), i.e. ‘spoke to himself’.

Verbs denoting reactive events, such as ‘deny’, are likewise not reflexive-marked in Gothic.

A variety of further event structures, mainly encompassing verbs expressing an attained state or some property, may nevertheless exhibit reflexive marking in Gothic. Such verbs include *anadrigkan* ‘be drunk’, *gahaban* ‘abstain, be abstinent’, *gakunnan* ‘be subdued, be subject to’.¹⁶ Each of these verbs is exemplified in turn in (64)–(66). In the case of *gakunnan* and *gahaban*, the reflexive is oppositional to a basic transitive usage (‘acknowledge’ and ‘take hold of’, respectively); *anadrigkan* is attested but once.

(64) *anadrigkan sik* ‘be drunk’, Eph. 5.18

<i>jah</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>anadrigkaiþ</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>weina,</i>	<i>in þammei</i>
and	not	be.drunk.NPST.	REFL.2PL.ACC	wine.DAT	in that.DAT
		IMP.2PL			
<i>ist</i>	<i>usstiurei</i>	...			
be.NPST.3SG	intemperance.NOM	...			
‘and be not drunk with wine, in that is intemperance’					

(65) *gahaban sik* ‘be abstinent’, 1 Thess. 4.3

<i>þata</i>	<i>auk</i>	<i>ist</i>	<i>wilja</i>	<i>gudis,</i>	<i>weihiþa</i>
this.NOM	for	be.NPST.3SG	will.NOM	god.GEN	sanctification.NOM
<i>izwara,</i>	<i>ei</i>	<i>gahabaiþ</i>	<i>izwis</i>	<i>af</i>	<i>kalkinassau[s]</i>
POSS.2PL.NOM	that	be.abstinent.NPST.2PL	REFL.2PL.ACC	from	fornication.DAT
‘for this is the will of god, your sanctification, that you should abstain from fornication’					

¹⁶ The verb *inswinþjan* ‘strengthen’ is employed with a direct reflexive to give the reading ‘strengthen oneself = be strong’.

(66) *gakunnan sik* 'be subdued, be subject to', 1 Cor. 15.28

<i>pan=uh</i>	<i>bipe</i>	<i>alla</i>	<i>gakunnun</i>	<i>sik</i>	
then=and	when	all.NOM.PL	be.subject.NPST.3PL	REFL.3.ACC	
<i>faura</i>	<i>imma,</i>	<i>pan=up=pan</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>silba</i>	
before	3SG.DAT	then=and=then	3SG.M.GEN	self.NOM	
<i>sunus</i>	<i>gakann</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>faura</i>	<i>pamma</i>	
son.NOM	be.subject.	REFL.3.ACC	before	this.DAT	
	NPST.3SG				
<i>ufhnaiwjandin</i>	<i>uf</i>	<i>ina</i>	<i>po</i>	<i>alla</i>	...
subjugate.PTCP.	under	3SG.M.ACC	the.ACC.PL	all.ACC.PL.N	...
NPST.DAT					
'and then when all things will be subject unto him, then the son will also himself be subject unto him that has subjugated all things under him'					

45. GROOMING

Is the construction used to denote grooming events? yes

46. GROOMING: NON-OPPOSITIONAL

If so, is the reflexive marker non-oppositional? yes

47. GROOMING: REDUNDANCY

Or is the marker redundant throughout the paradigm? yes

48. NONTRANSLATIONAL MOTION Is the construction used to denote grooming events? yes

49. NONTRANSLATIONAL MOTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: yes

50. NONTRANSLATIONAL MOTION: REDUNDANCY: yes

51. CHANGE IN BODY POSTURE

Is the construction used to denote changes in body posture? no

52. CHANGE IN BODY POSTURE: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA

53. CHANGE IN BODY POSTURE: REDUNDANCY: NA

54. TRANSLATIONAL MOTION

Is the construction used to denote translational motion? yes

55. TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: yes

56. TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: REDUNDANCY: yes

57. COGNITION

Is the construction used to denote cognitive processes? yes

58. COGNITION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: yes

59. COGNITION: REDUNDANCY: yes

60. EMOTION

Is the construction used to denote emotional states? yes

61. EMOTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: yes

62. EMOTION: REDUNDANCY yes no

63. EMOTIVE SPEECH ACTS

Is the construction used to denote emotive speech acts? no

64. EMOTIVE SPEECH ACTS: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA

- 65. EMOTIVE SPEECH ACTS: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 66. REACTION
Is the construction used to denote events in which agents react to some other event? no
- 67. REACTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 68. REACTION: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 69. OTHER TYPES
Is the construction used to other types of events? yes
- 70. OTHER TYPES: NON-OPPOSITIONAL no?
- 71. OTHER TYPES: REDUNDANCY no?

3.19.2 Construction 2

As mentioned at the outset of this section, the complex *sik silba* construction is not once found in use with a verb expressing any canonically middle semantics. This distributional asymmetry constitutes strong evidence that Construction 2 always fills an argument role, while a simple reflexive pronoun may do so, but is evidently the only option in cases where no further argument role is introduced.

- 45. GROOMING: no
- 46. GROOMING: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 47. GROOMING: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 48. NON-TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: no
- 49. NON-TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 50. NON-TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 51. CHANGE IN BODY POSTURE: no
- 52. CHANGE IN BODY POSTURE: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 53. CHANGE IN BODY POSTURE: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 54. TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: no
- 55. TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 56. TRANSLATIONAL MOTION: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 57. COGNITION: no
- 58. COGNITION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 59. COGNITION: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 60. EMOTION: no
- 61. EMOTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 62. EMOTION: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 63. EMOTIVE SPEECH ACT: no
- 64. EMOTIVE SPEECH ACT: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 65. EMOTIVE SPEECH ACT: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 66. REACTION: no
- 67. REACTION: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA

- 68. REACTION: REDUNDANCY: NA
- 69. OTHER TYPES: NO
- 70. OTHER TYPES: NON-OPPOSITIONAL: NA
- 71. OTHER TYPES: REDUNDANCY: NA

3.20 Telicity inversion

No instances of a reflexive construction that results in the inversion of the event's telicity are attested in Gothic.

3.20.1 Construction 1

- 72. TELICITY INVERSION

Is the construction used to invert the telicity of the denoted event? no

3.20.2 Construction 2

- 72. TELICITY INVERSION: NO

3.21 Equivalence set with pure intransitives

3.21.1 Construction 1

The verb *gahamon* 'dress oneself, put something on oneself' (as discussed at 3.19.1, see in particular examples (49) and (50)) is itself intransitive, but may optionally be extended with a reflexive pronoun coreferential with the verb's subject. Whether reflexives might optionally be used with any non-middle intransitives, however, is not entirely clear. The only possible example in the corpus is furnished by the verb *galaugnjan* 'remain hidden' or perhaps simply 'hide', but this depends upon whether the verb is properly to be understood as intransitive (i.e. 'be hidden, remain hidden') or transitive, and whether its semantics are to be regarded as belonging to the middle intransitives surveyed above. Three instances of this verb are intransitive, occurring in one instance with a reflexive (seen in (67)), which contrasts with the usage lacking a reflexive in (68). Given the uncertainties of *galaugnjan*, and the rarity of cases like it, it is more likely that reflexives are not permitted with non-middle intransitives in Gothic.

(67) *galaugnjan* ‘remain hidden; hide’ with reflexive, Luke 1.24

<i>afar=uh</i>	<i>þan</i>	<i>þans</i>	<i>dagans</i>	<i>inkilþo</i>
after=and	PTCL	that.ACC.PL	day.ACC.PL	pregnant.NOM
<i>warþ</i>	<i>Aileisabaiþ</i>	<i>qens</i>	<i>is</i>	<i>jah</i>
become.PST.3SG	E.	wife.NOM	3SG.GEN	and
<i>galaugnida</i>	<i>sik</i>	<i>menops</i>	<i>fimf</i>	
remain.hidden.PST.3SG	REFL.3.ACC	month.ACC.PL	five	
‘and after those days his wife Elisabeth became pregnant and remained hidden (/ hid herself) for five months’				

(68) *galaugnjan* ‘remain hidden; hide’ without reflexive, Mark 7.24

<i>jah</i>	<i>galeiþands</i>	<i>in</i>	<i>gard</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>wilda</i>
and	enter.PTCP.NPST.NOM	in	house.ACC	NEG	want.PST.3SG
<i>witan</i>	<i>mannan</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>ni</i>	<i>mahta</i>	<i>galaugnjan</i>
know.INF	man/one.INF	and	NEG	be.able.PST.3SG	remain.hidden.INF
‘and he entered into a house and did not want that anyone know it; but he could not remain hidden’					

73. INTRANSITIVE

Does the construction form an equivalence set with pure intransitives? no?

74. MARKER OBLIGATORY WITH INTRANSITIVES

If so, is the marker obligatory with some pure intransitive verbs? no

3.21.2 Construction 2

As far as the complex *sik silba* construction is concerned, no examples of a non-middle intransitive with this construction are in evidence; their cooccurrence may therefore be safely ruled out.

73. INTRANSITIVE: NO

74. MARKER OBLIGATORY WITH INTRANSITIVES: NA

3.22 Equivalence set with pure transitives

Gothic lacks deponent formations: when no coreference obtains between the participants of an event expressed by a transitive verb, reflexive pronouns coreferential with the verb’s subject are never employed.

3.22.1 Construction 1

75. TRANSITIVE

Does the construction form an equivalence set with pure transitives? no

76. OBLIGATORY WITH TRANSITIVES

If so, is the marker obligatory with some pure transitive verbs? NA

3.22.2 Construction 2

75. TRANSITIVE: NO

76. OBLIGATORY WITH TRANSITIVES: NA

3.23 Unpredictability

No cases are attested in Gothic in which the semantics of a reflexive construction are not straightforwardly, compositionally derivable from the semantics of the verb as employed outside a reflexive construction.

3.23.1 Construction 1

77. UNPREDICTABILITY Are there cases where the semantics of the reflexive construction is not predictable from the semantics of the non-reflexive counterpart? no

3.23.2 Construction 2

77. UNPREDICTABILITY: NO

3.24 Denominal reflexives

3.24.1 Construction 1

Denominal verbs in Gothic may, but certainly need not, be used with direct or indirect reflexive pronouns. Some denominative, deadjectival, or deadverbial verbs *might* be inherent reflexives, or at least allow themselves to be used with a reflexive construction. One plausible such case is presented by the verb *nehjan* ‘approach, draw near’ (cf. *atnehan*, mentioned under 3.19.1), derived from the adverb *nehva* ‘near, nigh’, which occurs with a reflexive in its single attestation, given in (69). The motivation for

the reflexive is likely that the resulting verb falls into the semantic class of translation-motional motion. In short, denominal, deadjectival, or deadverbial verbs in Gothic are not required to occur with reflexives simply in virtue of their derived character, though they are at least compatible with the simplex reflexive construction.

(69) *nehjan sik* ‘approach, draw near’, Luke 15.1

<i>wesun=up=þan</i>	<i>imma</i>	<i>nehjandans</i>	<i>sik</i>
be.PST.3PL=and=then	3SG.M.DAT	approach.PTCP.	REFL.3.ACC
		NPST.NOM.PL	
<i>allai</i>	<i>motarjos</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>frawaurhtai</i>
all.NOM.PL	tax.collector.NOM.PL	and	sinner.NOM.PL
<i>hausjan</i>	<i>imma</i>		
hear.INF	3SG.M.DAT		
‘and then all the tax collectors and sinners were drawing near to him to hear him’			

78. DENOMINAL REFLEXIVE

Can the reflexive construction be used in denominal verbs (in virtue of them being denominal)? no

3.24.2 Construction 2

While the corpus contains a number of secure instances of direct reflexives using the *sik silba* construction with denominative, deadjectival, or deadverbial verbs (e.g. *hnaiweiþ sik silban* ‘humbles himself’ at Luke 14.11, to *hnaiws* ‘lowly, humble’), there are no clear examples of this with an inherent or optionally reflexive verb. Given that complex *sik silba* has proved to be effectively limited to direct and indirect reflexives, it is on balance unlikely that any derived verbal stem would condition or optionally permit Construction 2.

78. DENOMINAL REFLEXIVE: no

3.25 Binding

3.25.1 Construction 1

Gothic permits long-distance reflexives in infinitival and participial clauses, as well as in DPs with embedded participles, even where another referent is the agent of the infinitive or participle, in which case the reflexive can refer back to an agent in the main clause. Two such cases of long-distance binding, involving an infinitive and a participial DP, are exemplified in (70) and (71), respectively. See Ferraresi 2005,

pp. 90–95, Harbert 1991, p. 34, Harbert 1978, pp. 47–55, Harbert 2007, pp. 197–204 for further discussion and examples of such binding phenomena, with comparison to other Germanic languages. Note further that the Gothic facts here accord with the typological generalization that long-distance reflexives tend to be morphologically simplex (Pica 1987 and Déchaine and Wiltschko 2017, p. 60): the simplex *sik* construction may indeed be employed in a long-distance reflexivization.

(70) Long-distance reflexive: infinitive, Mark 3.14

jah gawaurhta_i twalif_j [du wisan_j miþ sis_i]
 and appoint.PST.3SG twelve to be.INF with REFL.3.DAT
 ‘and he_i appointed twelve to stay with him_i’

(71) Long-distance reflexive: participial DP, Luke 14.12

is_i qapup=þan jah þamma_j haitandin_j sik_i
 3SG.M.NOM say.PST.3SG=then and that.DAT invite.PTCP.NPST.DAT REFL.3.ACC
 ‘then he_i said to the man (lit. that one) who invited him_i’

Apparent surface exceptions to such long-distance binding occur when the reflexive verb is a monovalent, inherent reflexive, including anticausatives (cf. (3.17) above). In such cases, a verb in an embedded clause may occur with simplex *sik*, which ought to be bound by the subject of the matrix clause. However, since the reflexive in such cases is not an argument, it cannot be anaphoric, and therefore appears to be “bound” by the subject of the embedded clause. In example (72), *warmjandan sik* ‘warming himself up’ is an oppositional anticausative to transitive *warmjan* ‘warm up’ (cf. German *wärmen*), and the simplex reflexive *sik* is not bound by the matrix subject ‘she (one of the maids of the high priest)’ – it does not mean ‘herself’ (cf. Miller 2019, p. 395 and Douse 1886, p. 234).

(72) Simplex *sik* not bound by matrix subject when non-anaphoric, Mark 14.67–68

...	<i>atiddja</i>	<i>aina</i>	<i>þiujo</i>	<i>þis</i>	<i>auhumistins</i>
...	come.PST.3SG	one.NOM	maid.NOM	the.GEN	high.GEN
<i>gudjins</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>gasaihvandei_i</i>	<i>Þaitru_j</i>	<i>warmjandan_j</i>	<i>sik_j</i> ,
priest.GEN	and	see.PTCP.NPST.	P.ACC	warm.up.PTCP.	REFL.3.ACC
		NOM		NPST.ACC	
<i>insaihvandei du</i>	<i>imma</i>	<i>qap</i>	...		
look.at.PTCP. to	3SG.M.DAT	speak.PST.			
NPST.NOM		3SG			

‘...a maid of the high priest came and saw Peter warming himself, and looked at him, and said...

However, as first observed in Hermodsson 1952, then further discussed in Rose 1976, Harbert 1978, pp. 55–64 and Ferraresi 2005, pp. 95–97, one finds (already in the Gospels, but systematically in the the *Skeireins*) instances of infinitival and participial

clauses in which a free pronoun is coreferential with the subject of the main clause. According to the sort of syntactic grammar capable of generating (70) and (71) above, it is the reflexive pronouns *sis* and *sik* which ought to occur in (73) below, rather than *imma* and *im*, respectively. At least for the later Gothic of the *Skeireins*, one might wish to reckon with a genuine syntactic change, whereby the type of long-distance reflexives seen above are no longer permitted.

(73) Free pronominal rather than reflexive in non-finite clause with coreference to subject of matrix clause

a. *Luke 1.73–74*

<i>ei</i>	<i>is_i</i>	<i>gebi</i>	<i>unsis</i>	<i>unagein</i>	<i>us</i>
that	3SG.M.NOM	give.PST.OPT.3SG	1PL.DAT	fearlessly	out.of
<i>handau</i>	<i>fijande</i>	<i>unsaraize</i>	<i>galausidaim</i>	<i>skalkinon</i>	<i>imma_i</i>
hand.DAT	enemy.	POSS.1PL.GEN.PL	deliver.PTCP.	serve.INF	3SG.DAT
	GEN.PL		PST.DAT.PL		

‘that he_i might give us fearlessly, delivered out of the hands of our enemies, to serve him_i’

b. *Skeireins* VIIIb.5

<i>eis_i</i>	<i>auk</i>	<i>andhofun</i>	<i>jainaim</i>	<i>anahaitandam</i>	<i>im_i</i>
they.NOM	for	answer.PST.3PL	also	those.3PL.DAT	rebuke.PTCP.
					NPST.DAT.PL 3PL.
					ACC

‘for they_i answered those ones rebuking them_i’

On the other hand, the single possible example in the corpus of a potentially logophoric usage of a reflexive pronoun also occurs in the *Skeireins*; this example is given in (74), where the logophoric reading is applied. See also the discussion of this example in Harbert 1991 and Ferraresi 2005, p. 95. Some translators of the passage, however, interpret *sis* as coreferential with the agent of the participles (*siponjam* ‘disciples’), giving a reciprocal reading (which would then, however, be the only instance of a reciprocal without *misso*; cf. 3.13). I regard the example as sufficiently uncertain in its interpretation that no clear decision concerning logophoricity in Gothic may be made; logophors, if permitted at all, are in any case very rare. Note further that, if this example is interpreted as a genuine instance of logophoricity, it would pose a potential counterexample to Déchaine Wiltschko’s (2017) distinction between D-reflexives (exemplified by the *sik silba* construction) and φ -reflexives (exemplified by the *sik*-construction): here, a construction that otherwise appears to behave as a φ -reflexive would be employed as a logophor.

(74) Logophoric *sis*? Skeireins IV.2

<i>eīþan</i>	<i>nu</i>	<i>siponjam</i>	<i>seinai_i</i>	<i>þaim</i>	<i>bi</i>
since	now	disciple.DAT.PL	POSS.REFL.3.DAT.PL	this.DAT.PL	about
<i>swikneim</i>	<i>du</i>	<i>Judaium</i>	<i>sokjandam</i>	<i>jah</i>	<i>qīþandam</i>
cleansing	to	jew.DAT.PL	seek(dispute).PTCP.	and	say.PTCP.NPST.DAT.PL
			NPST.DAT.PL		
<i>sis_i</i>					
REFL.3.DAT					
‘Since now his _i disciples _j had argued with the Jews about the purification and had said to him _i : ...’					

79. LONG-DISTANCE BINDING

Is the marker bound from outside its narrow domain? yes

80. LOGOPHOR

If so, is the marker used as a logophor? ?

3.25.2 Construction 2

In contrast to the simplex *sik* construction, which evidently can take part in long-distance reflexivization, usage of the complex *sik silba* construction in such cases with a long-distance reflexive reading would be ungrammatical in Gothic. For instance, if *sik* in (71) were substituted with *sik silban*, then the only grammatical reading would interpret *sik silban* as coreferential with the subject of the participle *haitandin*, not the free anaphor in the main clause, resulting in the interpretation ‘then he_i said to the that one_j who invited himself_j’. In other words, complex *sik silba* may only be bound within its narrow domain; compare further examples such as (11), (12), (32), or (33) for cases in which complex *sik silba* is bound locally in an infinitival or participial clause. Finally, no evidence points to possible logophoric uses of this construction.

79. LONG-DISTANCE BINDING: NO

80. LOGOPHOR: NO

3.26 Grammaticalization path

The stem of the Gothic dedicated reflexive pronoun (*sik*, *seina*, *sis*) directly continues the Proto-Indo-European reflexive pronoun **s(u)e-*, and is cognate with reflexive pronouns or markers attested in other Indo-European languages (e.g. Sanskrit *svá-*, Latin *sē*, Lithuanian *-si*, Old Church Slavic *se*). The same stem underlies the dedicated reflexive pronoun *sein-* discussed in 3.27 below. See e.g. Walde and Hofmann 1938, s.v. *suī*, Lehmann 1986, S-41, Kroonen 2013, s. v. *sīna-*, or Schuhmann 2021, s. v. *seins** for this

etymology. No clear pathway of grammaticalization or other historical origin for **s(u)e-* is recoverable within the internal history of Proto-Indo-European.

As for the component *silba-* of the *sik silba* construction, the form is inherited from Proto-Germanic **selba-* and shares cognates across both older and modern Germanic languages (Old High German *selb*, Old Norse *sjálf*, Old English *seolf*, German *selber*, Dutch *zelf*, English *self*, Swedish *själv*). At least a function as an intensifier, and likely a function as an expansion of reflexives formed with Proto-Germanic **si-*, should be reconstructed. Direct comparanda beyond Germanic are uncertain; Kluge and Seebold 2011, p. 841 suggest that Venetic *sselboisselboi* matches the doubled form *selbselbo* attested in Old High German, and that Celtic forms (Old Irish *selb* and *helw*, both ‘property, possession’) continue an identical Proto-Indo-European stem, **s(u)eluo-* (see Oettinger 1999 for the proposal of stem based on the reflexive pronoun **s(u)e-*, but a formation based on a verbal root **selH-* cannot be immediately excluded). If the connection with the Celtic forms is correct, and these are assumed to preserve the original lexical semantics of a proper noun meaning ‘possession’, then the grammaticalization of a content word inherited from Proto-Indo-European into a function word in Proto-Germanic must have occurred.

3.27 Reflexive possessives

Gothic possesses a specific reflexive possessive adjective, *sein-*, the paradigm of which (inflected for case, number, and gender) is shown in Table 4. Assorted examples of the reflexive possessive adjective’s usage may be found throughout this chapter, e.g. in examples (3), (62), or (74).

Tab. 4: Inflectional Paradigm of the 3rd Person Reflexive Possessive Adjective in Gothic

		M	F	N
SG	NOM	seins	seina	sein
	ACC	seinana	seina	sein
	GEN	seinis	seinazos	seinis
	DAT	seinamma	seinai	seinamma
PL	NOM	seinai	seinos	seina
	ACC	seinans	seinos	seina
	GEN	seinaze	seinaizo	seinaze
	DAT	seinaim	seinaim	seinaim

The adjective *sein-* is restricted to the third person, like the specific reflexive pronoun, *sik-*. No specialized reflexive possessive adjective exists for the first and second person; the general possessive adjectives *mein-* ‘my’, *þein-* ‘your’, etc. are also employed in

clauses where they are coreferential with the subject. However, *sein-* as well as *mein-* and *þein-* may be used together with *silba-*, inflected in the genitive, to produce a genitive phrase ‘one’s/my/your own’, as illustrated in (75) (cf. Miller 2019, p. 386).

(75) Luke 2.35

þeina silbons saiwala þairh-gaggiþ hairus
 POSS.2SG.ACC self.GEN soul.ACC through-go.NPST.3SG sword.NOM
 ‘a sword will pierce your (viz. Mary’s) own soul’

In general, *sein-* is strictly bound by a subject. There are some apparent surface exceptions, but Miller 2019, pp. 390–392 argues that these cases either present textual problems, or constitute cases of *sein-* employed as a discourse anaphor. Conversely, *sein-* appears to be obligatory when coreferential with a subject within the same clause (cf. Miller 2019, pp. 388–390); see again the examples involving *sein-* referred to immediately above. Finally, *sein-* never occurs doubled by another possessive pronoun.

81. POSSESSIVE

Does the language have a designated reflexive possessive? yes

82. PERSON RESTRICTIONS IN POSSESSIVES

Is the reflexive possessive restricted to certain persons? yes

83. SIMPLE POSSESSIVE

Is the marker used as a simple possessive pronoun, i.e. is it bound by another nominal than the subject? no

84. ALTERNATIVES

Is it possible to use non-reflexive pronouns alternatively if they are bound by the subject of their domain? no

85. POSSESSIVE DOUBLING

Can the reflexive possessive be doubled by another possessive pronoun? no

4 Summary

Gothic, the earliest substantially attested Germanic language and the only substantially attested member of the East Germanic subgroup, possesses two reflexive constructions, both of which are characterized by the employ of reflexive pronouns. The simplex *sik* construction consists of the reflexive pronoun alone, while the complex *sik silba* construction shows a pronoun immediately followed by a form of an intensifier ‘self’. On the whole, the Gothic reflexive constructions closely resemble those of many other Germanic languages, if not in every detail or the specific particular combination of every typological feature surveyed here; the Gothic two-reflexive system, with a distinction between a D-reflexive (*sik silba*) and a ϕ -reflexive (*sik*), bears particular similarities to the situation in Dutch and in Scandinavian languages. For comparative perspectives on the grammar of reflexives in the Germanic family, see Harbert

2007, pp. 196–214 or Gast 2006. For the convenience of the reader, I outline here the major features of Gothic reflexives, with reference to the relevant sections above.

- The functions of direct, indirect, and inherent reflexives in Gothic are expressed exclusively through the use of pronouns, which are available only in non-nominative cases (2). These pronouns are formally identical with the personal pronouns in the first (*mik*) and second (*buk*) persons, but a dedicated, number-indifferent, reflexive pronoun exists for the third person (*sik*; 3.1).
- Based on the fact that the simple reflexive pronoun almost exclusively follows the verb of its clause (3.2), the reflexive pronominals are likely to be clitics (3.6). Direct phonological cues to cliticness are not, however, readily available (3.7).
- A reflexive pronoun may be expanded with a following intensifier *silba-* (2, 3.5) to yield the complex *sik silba* construction, which builds a full DP, and may then be moved out of the default postverbal position (3.2.2). This full DP may be coordinated and may participate in equations (3.4).
- The usage and distribution of the simple reflexive pronoun versus the complex reflexive anaphor with *silba-* parallel the two-reflexive system found in other Germanic languages: only the simplex reflexive is permitted when not associated with a semantic argument role, otherwise both options are possible, with complex anaphor seemingly preferred for direct and indirect reflexives in the first and second person (2, 3.5).
- Reflexives may readily occur in non-finite clauses, and the dedicated reflexive pronoun is normally obligatory when bound by the subject of its domain (3.10, 3.25).
- Direct reflexives are common in the corpus (pronoun normally in ACC), and a number of indirect reflexives are attested (pronoun in DAT). See 3.11 and 3.12.
- Reciprocal constructions are built with the simplex reflexive pronoun plus an obligatory further adverb *misso* ‘each other’ (3.13).
- The simplex *sik* construction may be employed for the derivation of oppositional anticausatives (3.17), but apparently no reflexives are used to build passives, anti-passives, facilitatives, or impersonals.
- The simplex *sik* construction is employed with verbs encompassing many of the semantic fields described by Kemmer 1994 as middles, including verbs of grooming, translational and nontranslational motion, changes in body posture, cognition, and emotion (3.19).
- The usage of reflexives with any pure intransitives is doubtful (3.21), and they are certainly not used to construct deponents (3.22) or induce changes in telicity (3.20).
- Simplex reflexives are permitted to be bound at long distance in infinitival and participial clauses or DPs with an embedded participle (3.25). Exactly one possibly logophoric usage occurs in the corpus.
- A dedicated possessive reflexive pronoun, *sein-*, exists, and is obligatory when bound by the subject of its domain (3.27).

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